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IN BRIEF



Denial of nod for U.S. trip an insult to Telangana: CM

HYDERABAD
Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Monday termed the Centre's refusal to grant political clearance for his proposed visit to the United States an "insult" to Telangana. » **Page 5**

Manipur awaits Centre's decision on Census 2027

NEW DELHI
Manipur is awaiting a decision from New Delhi regarding the upcoming Census, which remains in limbo in the State amid the demand by several civil society groups for a National Register of Citizens to be compiled first. » **Page 10**

Three newborns killed in Maharashtra hospital fire

36 infants rescued from the SNCU of District Women's Hospital in Amravati; blaze started after a ventilator exploded, say police; seven-member panel to probe the incident, says Health Minister

Yohan Varghese
MUMBAI

Three newborns were killed and 36 were rescued after a fire broke out at the Special Newborn Care Unit (SNCU) of the District Women's Hospital in Amravati, Maharashtra, in the early hours of Monday. The police said the blaze started after a ventilator exploded and caught fire on the third floor of the unit. Six infants were rescued from the affected area, and the flames were doused in 10 to 15 minutes.

At the time of the fire, 39 newborns were admitted to the SNCU, which provides treatment to premature babies and newborns who have low birth weight and are in a critical condition.



Relatives of an infant victim of the fire mourning near the District Women's Hospital in Amravati, Maharashtra, on Monday. PTI

Sources said doctors, nurses, and other hospital staff rushed to the ward after the fire broke out and began evacuating the babies. They disconnected the medical equipment and shifted the infants to safety as rescue operations got under way.

A nurse who was on du-

ty said: "While the ventilator was burning, we removed the babies. I can't describe it - it was terrible. The babies were burning next to it, we rescued them, extracted the incubator, and shifted them."

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis called the incident "heart-

breaking" and ordered a high-level probe. "The health administration has been directed to conduct a high-level inquiry," he said in a statement, adding that strict action will be taken against those found culpable. He announced ex gratia of ₹5 lakh to the family of each deceased infant.

Health Minister Prakash Abitkar, who rushed to Amravati, flagged "grave" irregularities at the fire-hit hospital and said a seven-member panel would probe the blaze and submit its report within eight days.

"The situation here is horrific and unfortunate. Whatever irregularities were there at the hospital were grave ones," he told presspersons.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

T.N. drops Parandur airport project; new sites 'identified'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday announced his government's decision to drop the proposed airport project in Parandur and identify alternative sites for a second airport in Chennai.

Making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly, he said a new terminal, Terminal 5, would be developed in the north-western part of the Chennai airport in collaboration with the Airports Authority of India (AAI), along with an approach road and a flyover.

The main Opposition DMK sought to speak on the issue, but Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar said he would not allow a debate on an announcement made under Rule 110 of the Assembly.

Former Finance Minister Thangam Thennarasu said he was not seeking a debate but wanted to clarify. DMK members then



The [alternative] site will be finalised after studying the technical feasibility and consulting the departments concerned

C. JOSEPH VIJAY
Tamil Nadu Chief Minister

walked out after the Speaker stood his ground.

'Experts consulted'

The Chief Minister said he had consulted experts on the creation of a new airport and that a few alternative sites had been identified that would cause minimal damage to farmland and human settlements. "The site will be finalised after studying the technical feasibility and consulting the departments concerned," he said, recalling his visit to Parandur in 2025 to express solidarity with protesting farmers and his earlier an-

nouncement at Vikravandi opposing the project.

Mr. Vijay said he was fully aware of the role of airports in industrial development but maintained that an airport should not be built at Parandur as it would affect vast tracts of farmland and human settlements. He said the Chennai airport currently handled 30 million passengers a year. "After the completion of Terminal 5, the passenger capacity will increase to 55 million a year. It will improve the services and transport facilities until a new airport is completed," he said.

Mahto launches yatra for recruitment exam reforms in Jharkhand

Amit Bhelari
RAMGARH

Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha leader Devendra Nath Mahto on Monday launched the Bharti Vyavastha Sudhar Yatra, a Statewide march seeking reforms in government recruitment exams.

Mr. Mahto was one of the prominent faces of the 26-day student protest that began on July 25 in Ranchi against alleged irregularities in recruitment exams.

The State government on August 18 cancelled 22 tests and ordered a probe into 23 others conducted since 2014. However, the High Court later stayed notifications cancelling ap-

pointments made through government exams.

Mr. Mahto kicked off the yatra from Nemra village, the birthplace of Shibu Soren in Ramgarh district, after garlanding the statue of the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha co-founder and former Chief Minister. He said the march is aimed at demanding a fair and corruption-free recruitment system for government jobs.

The residents of Nemra staged a road blockade to protest against alleged plans to burn the effigy of Chief Minister Hemant Soren. However, after the launch of the yatra, Mr. Mahto and his team did not move towards the ancestral house of Shibu Soren.

Braving the weather



Rough outing: Fishing boats seen off the Visakhapatnam coast on Monday despite the India Meteorological Department's advisory against venturing into the sea until Tuesday as conditions along the north Andhra Pradesh coast is expected to stay rough to very rough. K.R. DEEPAK

Over 1 crore names deleted in Karnataka draft electoral rolls

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

With the removal of over 1.07 crore names, Karnataka's electorate shrunk to 4.46 crore voters with the draft electoral rolls published on Monday as part of the special intensive revision (SIR). An overwhelming number of the missing names were marked "absent, shifted, duplicate, dead, and others (ASDDO)".

Announcing the figures at the end of the enumeration phase, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V. Anbu Kumar said the electorate comprised over 2.22 crore men, 2.24 crore women, and 2,871 others. Voters can check their names on the CEO's official website.

The CEO said a special campaign will be held in areas reporting high ASDO numbers, where voters will be assisted in filling Form 6 (for inclusion). The dates for the campaign are yet to be announced by the CEO's office.

Discrepancy notices

As many as 43.81 lakh notices will be served on voters whose enumeration forms contained logical discrepancies or those who could not be mapped. Notices may also be issued if a complaint is filed against a voter or if the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) has reason to suspect that a voter is ineligible.

With the enumeration phase ending, voters are likely to face the same problems they encountered with the ASDDO list. Just as people remained unaware that their names were on the ASDDO list un-

Breaking down draft deletions in Telangana SIR

Driven by a deletion rate of 35% or more in Hyderabad and adjoining urban areas, Telangana has registered the highest deletion rate — 21.7% in the enumeration phase of the SIR process in the country. In contrast to northern States though, the gender ratio in the draft rolls improved from 1,018 to 1,028. » **PAGE 7**

til 12 days before the enumeration phase ended, they now have no way of knowing whether they will receive a notice until one is actually served.

"We only have numbers on how many people will receive notices, and the names will not be known until the notice is generated," the CEO said.

Hurdles for voters

The entire process — from an ERO generating a notice to it being served — is to be completed within just seven days. This could become a major hurdle, especially for voters living in another district or city while remaining registered in their native constituency, as the voter must attend the hearing in person.

There is, so far, no online option to check whether a person is likely to receive a notice.

The CEO reiterated that the names will be known only after a notice is generated. The process has now placed the burden of saving one's vote squarely on the voter.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**



EDUCATION TO EMPLOYMENT
Modi govt. 'ravaging' Indian youth: Cong.

NEWS » PAGE 11

CRPF sub-inspector injured, two houses torched as two groups clash in Manipur

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) sub-inspector was injured and at least two houses were torched after violence erupted between two groups in Manipur on Monday.

Officials in Imphal said unknown miscreants burnt a house in the Taphou Kuki village in the Kuki-dominated Kangpokpi district in the early hours. Soon after, another house was torched at Taphou Naga village in the adjoining Naga-dominated Senapati district.

As tension mounted, two groups exchanged fire after 9 a.m. The CRPF sub-inspector was caught in the



Burning streets: A road blocked by local people amid reports of violence in Senapati, Manipur, on Monday. ANI

crossfire and got shot. He was later admitted to a local hospital.

Local people in Senapati blocked National Highway no. 2, also known as the Imphal-Dimapur (Nagaland) road, for a few hours

after the violence. Following the incidents, the security forces heightened alert along the highway and in vulnerable villages in the two districts.

The Taphou Kuki village authority condemned the

"highly deplorable, inhuman, and unacceptable" arson attack, appealing to individuals and groups to refrain from violence, destruction of property, and any actions that may further escalate tension and suffering among the people.

Probe sought

"We urge the district administration, police, and other competent authorities to take immediate and appropriate action to investigate the incident, identify those responsible, and ensure that justice is delivered in accordance with the law," the village authority said in a statement.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

Lost in the seat matrix: engineering season begins in T.N.

In December 2023, the State Planning Commission published a study of its analysis of semester-end engineering question papers, stating that the assessment quality was largely below par. The questions mostly conformed to the lower cognitive levels of Bloom's Taxonomy, while lacking analytical depth. The clamour for reforms has been growing since then, but a curriculum revamp has been long overdue. Successive governments had in the past given in to status quoism, while indulging in chest-thumping over the State's reported 52% Gross Enrolment Ratio in higher education. The new dispensation and its will to effect a change will be tested as it presents the demand for grants for higher education in the Assembly on Monday.

Youth group marches to Deoria DM office over FIR

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Activists of Justice Morcha, a forum of youths raising issues related to employment and education in Uttar Pradesh, on Monday marched to the District Magistrate's (DM) office in Deoria to demand action on poor school infrastructure.

The action comes days after one of its members was booked for allegedly entering and filming a school in Damar Bishwa village in Gauribazar without authorisation and spreading misinformation.

The Deoria police on Saturday registered an FIR against Rajat Singh under Sections 329(4) and 353(2) of the BNS based on a complaint filed by Gauribazar Block Education Officer Vinay Sheel Mishra.

"Today, when our activists reached Deoria DM Madhusudan Hulgi's office regarding the matter, he immediately left. We are only demanding that critical gaps in school infrastructure be addressed," said Abhinav Mishra, a Justice Morcha member.

Senior State Congress leader Ajay Kumar 'Lallu' reacted sharply to the police action, calling it a "nefarious attempt to silence youth voices".

Unauthorised entry won't be allowed in Haryana govt. schools: Education Minister

Safety of students can't be compromised for political publicity, says Mahipal Dhanda; move comes after CJP activists visit schools in State and allege deficiencies in infrastructure, quality of meals

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Haryana Education Minister Mahipal Dhanda on Monday said unauthorised entry will not be allowed in government schools in the State. His remarks came after Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists visited government schools in several villages in the State over the past two weeks as part of its 'School Thik Karo' campaign. They alleged deficiencies in infrastructure, cleanliness, availability of teachers, and quality of midday meals.

'National heritage'
Addressing reporters in Hansi, Mr. Dhanda termed government schools a "national heritage" and said the "safety of students cannot be compromised for political publicity". He said anyone visiting a government school should do so in coordination with members of the panchayat and the school management committee (SMC).



Education Minister Mahipal Dhanda (left) said people with genuine complaints should approach the authorities. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

"The sarpanch is there, elected representatives of the panchayat are there. There is an SMC in all schools. Anyone visiting must take along SMC and panchayat members," the Minister said, adding that the responsibility would be fixed if disturbances occur on the school premises during such visits.

Mr. Dhanda said people with genuine complaints about a government school should first approach the sarpanch and

other responsible authorities.

CJP national core committee member Sudhir Sangwan told *The Hindu* that the group had so far visited 16 to 17 schools across districts such as Jhajjar, Bhiwani, Charkhi Dadri, and Fatehabad.

'Teacher suspended'
He claimed that a teacher was suspended in Bhiwani after a CJP activist raised concerns over the quality of foodgrains supplied for

the midday meal. He added that CJP activists plan to visit 100 more schools in the State over the next fortnight, with the objective of highlighting shortcomings and demanding greater accountability and better execution.

'Invited by villagers'
Reacting to the Minister's remarks, Mr. Sangwan said CJP activists entered schools only after they were invited by villagers who wanted improvements in their schools.

He questioned the effectiveness of the SMCs, saying though they were set up to function as watchdogs, their members were often inactive or lacked the capacity to monitor schools effectively.

Mr. Sangwan also shared on X an order issued by the Hansi district administration restricting unauthorised entry into schools and criticised the move as an attempt to prevent people from documenting the condition of government schools.

Delhi HC seeks rationale for MP/MLA endorsement to get Lakshmi Yojana aid

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Monday asked the Delhi government to file an affidavit within 10 days explaining why women seeking financial assistance under the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana must obtain an endorsement from their MP or MLA.

A Bench of Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia questioned the rationale for making endorsement from an elected representative mandatory for every applicant to the scheme, which provides financial assistance of ₹2,500 a month.

The court sought the government's response while hearing a plea by former Congress councillor Abhishek Dutt and Aya Nagar councillor Vedpal Sheetal Chaudhary, challenging the provision and arguing that it gives political representatives "unbridled discretion" and effectively turns a welfare entitlement into an "instrument of political patronage".

"Let a short affidavit be filed by respondent No. 1 (Delhi government) giving the rationale... and indicate what objective they are seeking to achieve by adding this clause in the scheme," stated the Bench.

The court asked the Delhi govt. to explain what objectives it seeks to achieve by adding this clause to the scheme

Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Chetan Sharma, appearing for the Delhi government, defended the provision, submitting that similar schemes operated in other States and that such requirements exist across the country. He said around 6.1 lakh beneficiaries had already been added under the scheme.

The matter will be heard next on October 17.

The scheme became operational on August 1 with the launch of an online registration portal. Under the scheme, women aged 21 to 60 with an annual family income of up to ₹2.5 lakh are eligible to apply. Income-tax payers and government employees are excluded. Families with more than three children, annual electricity consumption above 2,400 units, ownership of a four-wheeler or a member in government service are also not eligible. The guidelines further provide that the eldest eligible woman in a family can apply.

Cong. protests FIRs against IYC workers in Haryana

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Led by Haryana Pradesh Congress Committee (HPCC) president Rao Narender Singh, party leaders and workers staged a demonstration in Gurugram against the FIRs registered against Indian Youth Congress (IYC) and NSUI workers and student leaders for allegedly waving black flags at Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini during his visit to the city on August 21.

Later, party leaders submitted a memorandum to the Gurugram Police Commissioner, demanding immediate, impartial and transparent action in the matter.

Mr. Singh demanded withdrawal of the FIRs re-



Haryana Congress president Rao Narender Singh during a protest rally in Gurugram on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

gistered against Youth Congress and NSUI workers, as well as the district presidents of Gurugram Rural and Gurugram Urban. He also called for an immediate end to the alleged harassment and intimidation of Congress workers and their families.

He also demanded independent medical examina-

tions of youth workers, student leaders and district presidents who have alleged assault or harassment while in police custody. He also sought preservation of CCTV footage from the relevant locations and legal and departmental action against police personnel found responsible for any wrongdoing.

6 held for running fake airline job racket; victims from Delhi, neighbouring States

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

From a small room in a commercial building in Noida Sector 62, three women posing as HR executives at an airline company spent their days calling young jobseekers and offering them roles at Indira Gandhi International Airport. Ex-

cept, the airline did not exist. Neither did the aviation institute they claimed candidates had to enrol in before joining.

The telecallers were arrested last week, along with the alleged mastermind and two other accomplices, for duping job aspirants from Delhi, Chandigarh, Haryana and Punjab, the

Delhi police said. Ten victims have been identified so far, said an officer.

The accused collected between ₹7,000 and ₹10,000 from each victim as "registration" or "admission fee", the police said. The crime came to light after Vikas Kumar, of Paharganj, came across an Instagram advertisement

offering a job at "Bretish Airways". After filling in his details, he received a call from a woman who collected his PAN and Aadhaar details, marksheets, and resume via WhatsApp and told him that a diploma in aviation or airport management from "Future Wings Learning Institute" was mandatory.

Mumbai Weather

	max	min
Mumbai Airport	32	25
Pune	28	22
Mumbai City	32	25

Mumbai Today
30°C The weather will be slight warm. Spell of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower will occur. Night will be comfortable.

Mumbai Tomorrow
31°C The weather to remain slight warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower to occur.

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THE HINDU

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Timings
MUMBAI

TUESDAY, AUG. 25		
RISE	06:22	SET 18:59
RISE	17:14	SET 03:38
WEDNESDAY, AUG. 26		
RISE	06:22	SET 18:58
RISE	17:53	SET 04:32
THURSDAY, AUG. 27		
RISE	06:23	SET 18:58
RISE	18:30	SET 05:26

THE HINDU

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BBRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Office of the Assistant Commissioner, G/N Ward, 1st Floor,
Harishchandra Yelve Marg, Dadar (W), Mumbai-28.
No.: PCO/GN/44/SR; Date: 24/08/2026

NOTICE

Applications are invited from registered Sahakari / Berojgar Seva Sahakari Sansthas, for providing 43 Volunteers to render Insecticidal treatment at Building Construction sites for 05 Months (122 days) to control Dengue & Malaria in G/North ward.

Interested Sanstha's should download applications on B.M.C. portal <http://portal.mcgm.gov.in> or contact at the office of the Pest Control Officer, G/North Ward, Harishchandra Yelve Marg, Room No. 324, 3rd Floor, Dadar (West), Mumbai-400 028, Tel. No. 024397998.

The last date for submission of applications at the office of Pest Control Officer is **04.09.2026 before 2.00 p.m.** on working days.

PRO/1182/ADV/2026-27
Avoid self medication

Sd/-
Assistant Commissioner- G/North Ward

WESTERN RAILWAY
SIGNALLING WORK

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer (South), 2nd Floor, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Mumbai Central, Mumbai-400 008, invites **E-Tender No.: W_420_2_297_SG_WA_R1** Dated: 20/08/2026. Name of Work: Signalling work in connection with Construction of new Road Over Bridge at Prabhadevi station (Elphinstone Road- Carol bridge) at Km 8-9 by MRIDCL of Mumbai Division Western Railway. Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 51,40,896.63. EMD: ₹ 1,02,800/-. Date & Time for Closure for Submission of E-Tender Documents: Till 16.09.2026, 15:00 hrs. Date & Time for Opening of E-Tender: On 16.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs. The tender can be viewed at website www.ireps.gov.in 0509

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SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Publication of Tender Notice No. CAO/CN/BNC/194/2026 Dated: 18-08-2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following work:

Item of work	Approx. Value
Construction of additional loop line with Electrification, Extension of minor bridges, Extension of FOB, Construction of Type-II quarters, Rest House, Platform & Development area and other allied works at Dodbete station between Yasvantpur-Tumakuru section on South Western Railway (Composite Work). (Tender Ref. No: YPTK-DBL-ADDL-LOOPLINE-R)	Rs.15,12,42,737/-

Last date for submission of bids: Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 11-09-2026

For details log on to: www.ireps.gov.in

Deputy Chief Engineer/Construction/Works
Bengaluru Cantonment

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WESTERN RAILWAY
BRIDGE PAINTING WORK

DY. CE (Bridge-Line), Western Railway, Dadar invites E-Tender No: **DYCE-BR-DDR-2026-08**. Name of Work: "Painting of major steel girder Bridge No. 23A UP/DN Harbour (OWG). 27 UP/DN Harbour, 31 UP/DN Harbour, 31 UP/DN Harbour, Local, 31 UP/DN Through, 31 STA, 56STA, 46 UP/DN Through, 46 STA, Turn Table Bandra, 92 UP/DN and 93 UP/DN between Churchgate - Virar - Saphale section and Br. No. 166 UP, 166 DN, 169 UP & 169 DN in Virar-Surat section in the Jurisdiction of ADENB/Valsad of Mumbai Division." Approximate Cost of the Work: ₹ 78,38,537.68. EMD: ₹ 1,56,800/-. Date and Time for Submission of E-Tender and Opening of E-Tender: On line tender is to be submitted on 18.09.2026 before 15:00 Hrs., and is to be opened on same date - 18.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. Website particulars and notice for location where complete details can be seen etc.: Website @ www.ireps.gov.in 0512

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BANARAS LOCOMOTIVE WORKS, VARANASI-221004
No. PR/69/A.A./Part-XIII Dated: 08.03.2025

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Notice inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) for empanelment of Private/Reputed Hospitals/Diagnostic centres in Varanasi for extending investigative facilities including pathology, radiological –MRI/CT Scan, PET Scan, Special investigations etc. for the railway beneficiaries of diesel locomotive works.

Principal Chief Medical Officer, Banaras Locomotive Works, Varanasi invites sealed Expression of Interest (EOI) for empanelment of Private/Reputed Hospitals/ Diagnostic centres/CGHS approved centres in Varanasi for extending investigative facilities including pathology, radiological –MRI/CT Scan, PET Scan, Special investigations etc. for the railway beneficiaries of Banaras Locomotive Works on cashless basis at CGHS rates for Tier II (Y City).

Interested Private/Reputed Hospitals/Diagnostic centres are advised to submit the E.O.I. for above investigations in sealed envelope in Tender Box of Principal Chief Medical Officer's office, Banaras Locomotive Works by 21.09.2026 (uptil 15:00 hrs).

Special Notice:- Terms and condition and application format can be down loaded from our website: <http://www.blw.indianrailways.gov.in>

PR/BLW/Med-02 Sr. DMO/Admin.

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APPOINTMENT

इण्डियन ओवरसीज़ बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
भारतीय ओवरसीज़ बैंक

Human Resources Management Department
Central Office, 763, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600002

RECRUITMENT OF SECURITY GUARDS

Indian Overseas Bank, a leading Public Sector Bank with headquarters in Chennai having geographical presence all over India and abroad, invites applications from eligible candidates, for the captioned recruitment. The detailed advertisement regarding the eligibility such as Qualification, Experience & Other requirements are available in the Bank's website www.iob.bank.in under "Careers" page. Candidates to apply online through Bank's website www.iob.bank.in.

DATE FOR ONLINE REGISTRATION: STARTS ON 25.08.2026 - ENDS ON 14.09.2026 (BOTH DAYS INCLUSIVE)

TAMILNADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)

Office Address: CMDA, Tower II, 4th Floor, Gandhi Irwin Bridge Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. E-Mail: tasmacrvt2015@gmail.com

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Online Tender is invited by the Managing Director, TASMAC for "Selection of a System Operator for Deployment and Operation of Reverse Vending Machines for Collection of Post-Consumer Liquor Bottles/Containers with Incentive Mechanism in Tamil Nadu under QCBS Method".

Sl. No	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bid
1.	Online Tender for "Selection of a System Operator for Deployment and Operation of Reverse Vending Machines for Collection of Post-Consumer Liquor Bottles/Containers with Incentive Mechanism in Tamil Nadu under QCBS Method".	R3/8849/2021 Dated: 24.08.2026	31.08.2026 at 11:00 AM to 05.10.2026 upto 11:00 AM	28.09.2026 at 11:00 AM to 05.10.2026 Upto 11:00 AM	05.10.2026 at 12:00 Noon

The tender related documents can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at <https://tntenders.gov.in/>.

Tender Inviting Authority / Managing Director
TASMAC Ltd.

DIPR/2660/Tender/2026

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PUBLIC NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE XV ADDL. DIST. JUDGE, R.R.DISTRICT. AT: IBRAHIMPATNAM I.A. No. 823 of 2025 & I.A. No. 824 of 2025 & I.A. No. 825 of 2025 IN O.S. No. 1161 of 2024

Between: Indarpal Singh Sahni,Petitioner/Plaintiff And Ajit Kaur Sahani (died per L.Rs) & othersRespondents/Defendants

To: 1. Mrs. Satinder Kaur Gadh, D/o, Birnder Singh Sahni, aged 62 years, 2. Miss. Harleen Kaur Sahni, D/o, Birnder Singh Sahni, aged 60 years, Both R/O, 3rd floor, Eudora Building, 17th Road, Khair (W), Mumbai-400052.

Please hereby take notice that the petitioner /plaintiff have filed the above case against the Ajit Kaur Sahni on the life of the XV Addl. District Judge, R.R.District at Ibrahimpatnam vide O.S. No.1161 of 2024. Since Ajit Kaur died petitioners have been filed to bring you on record being the legal heirs of Ajit Kaur, as she died. The said case is posted on 02-09-2026 for your appearance. So, please make it convenient to appear before above said court on 02-09-2026 at 10.30 A.M., failing which you will be set apart.

Hence, this notice as per the orders of the Hon'ble Court.

Sd/- G. SATHYAVEER REDDY G. PRABHAKAR REDDY Advocates

H.No. 16-1-30/A/29, Saidabad Colony, Hyderabad, Cell: 9652431102, 9391034146

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL JUNIOR CIVIL JUDGE, KAKINADA O.S. No.269 / 2025

Between: M/s. Sri Ramadas Motor Transport Ltd., Rep. by its Transport Manager, KakinadaPlaintiff and Yakkala Venkata Ramana Sundara Rao & othersDefendants

To: M/s. Wallace Pharmaceuticals Pvt. Ltd., BHC-V, Wallace Towers, 5th Floor, 139-140(B/1), Western Express Highway, Vile Parle (East), Mumbai-400 057, Maharashtra State, Rep. by its Managing Director.

(Defendant No.3 in the above suit)

To Defendant No.3 in the above numbered Suit O.S. No. 269 of 2025. The Hon'ble Court has sent notices to you several times, but you are intentionally avoiding receiving them / causing delay. Therefore, the Hon'ble Court has adjourned the matter to 09-09-2026 for your appearance.

Accordingly, on that day at 10:30 A.M. you shall appear before the Hon'ble Court either in person or through your advocate and make known your objections. Failing which, the said suit will be decided in your absence (ex-parte).

(As per the orders of the Hon'ble Court.)

VINJAMURI VENKATA RAO Advocate, D.No.11-15-13, Ramaraopet Kakinada, A.P., Cell: 9866550610

INBRIEF



Provide cow to woman seeking self-reliance: U.P. CM to officials

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Monday instructed officials to provide an abandoned cow to a woman who expressed her desire to rear cows during a ‘Janata Darshan’ event in Lucknow, according to an official statement. In response to her request, the Chief Minister directed the Additional Chief Secretary of Animal Husbandry Department to ensure she received an abandoned cow and the benefits of any applicable government schemes. In her application to Mr. Adityanath, Poonam Devi stated that she wanted to become self-reliant through cow rearing. PTI

Assault case: HC rejects bail petition of Gujarat AAP MLA

The Gujarat High Court on Monday rejected the bail plea of Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MLA Chaitar Vasava in an assault and extortion case in which he was sentenced to seven years’ imprisonment along with eight others by a sessions court. Vasava has not yet been disqualified as a member of the State Assembly. A single Bench of Justice Vimal K. Vyas rejected Vasava’s plea for suspension of sentence and observed that being a member of the Assembly, he ought to have guided the aggrieved persons to seek lawful remedies rather than resort to intimidation and coerce government employees. PTI

Row over U.P. IAS officer’s ‘bid’ to influence civil judge deepens as HC takes serious exception

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The controversy surrounding allegations that senior IAS officer and Devipatan Divisional Commissioner Durga Shakti Nagpal attempted to exert pressure on a civil judge intensified on Monday, with civil society members demanding a high-level probe by the Uttar Pradesh government.

The demand comes after the Allahabad High Court’s Lucknow Bench on Friday took serious exception to the allegation.

The Gonda civil judge, in a letter to the district judge, earlier alleged that she received repeated phone calls while on leave on July 15 from a number linked to the Devipatan Division Commissioner’s office, headquartered in Gonda. According to her, Ms. Nag-

The judge alleged that the IAS officer attempted to discuss a pending case over repeated phone calls

pal, who wanted to discuss a long-pending land dispute, asked pointed questions about how long the judge intended to stay on leave. She also said the “phone calls and the tone used amounted to interference”.

The High Court observed that the pressure prima facie exerted by Ms. Nagpal “struck at the independence of the judiciary and obstructed the administration of justice”.

Ms. Nagpal, however, said she had not tried to discuss the merits of the case and had only sought to know when the judge would resume hearing the

matter. Justice Syed Qamar Hasan Rizvi held that the allegations could not simply be ignored, and directed that the matter be placed before the appropriate Bench dealing with criminal contempt. Justice Rizvi noted that the tone of the alleged conversation showed the judge was being pressured. The court directed that the matter be placed before the appropriate Bench after seeking directions from the Chief Justice or the senior judge.

“I have sent a letter to the Chief Secretary demanding the transfer of Durga Shakti Nagpal and an independent inquiry,” activist Amitabh Thakur said. He has also demanded clear protocols to be issued regarding officials contacting judicial officers over pending cases.

Another KSU leader arrested for Shillong violence; 15 FIRs filed

Press Trust of India
SHILLONG

The Meghalaya police on Monday arrested another leader of the Khasi Students Union, alleged to be one of five masked persons identified in connection with the August 19 violence during the outfit’s black-flag bike rally in Shillong, particularly attacks on Assam-registered vehicles.

KSU assistant organising secretary Jeremiah Pohthmi was arrested from the city’s Nongmensong area, East Khasi Hills SP Vivek Syiem told reporters.

Police produced him before a court and sought his custody for further investigation, the SP said.

Pohthmi’s arrest comes days after police arrested

three senior KSU leaders – president Raymond Kharjana, vice-president Pynkmenlang Sanmiet and general secretary Reuben Najiar – in connection with the same case.

13 vehicles damaged

The August 19 rally, which had been permitted by the East Khasi Hills district administration, turned violent when some participants allegedly pelted stones at vehicles and attacked bystanders. At least 31 vehicles were damaged, and 18 people were injured in the violence, according to the state government.

CM Conrad K. Sangma on Monday informed the Assembly that 15 FIRs had been filed in connection with the violence.

Stone quarries and crushers in the vicinity put Assam’s semiconductor plant at risk

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Dust-producing stone quarries and crushers in the vicinity could cripple Assam’s semiconductor unit, a signature pet project of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, before it can start, an environmental activist has warned.

The ₹27,000 crore Tata Semiconductor Assembly and Test (TSAT) facility is being developed in Morigaon district’s Jagiroad, about 55 km east of Guwahati. It is a major component of India’s chip-making ambitions and is linked to the vision of building a self-reliant ecosystem under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM).

Over 60% of the work at the TSAT facility, coming up where a unit of the Hin-



Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma inspecting progress of the semiconductor project at Jagiroad near Guwahati. FILE PHOTO

dustan Paper Corporation once stood, is complete.

According to the ISM guidelines, a semiconductor plant requires ISO Class 1 to 5 vibration-damped cleanrooms to prevent microscopic dust contamination, and millions of gallons of ultra-pure water daily for wafer-rising, chemical processing, and cooling.

However, stone quarries



The law also does away with the old rule that required eligible industrial and village cooperatives to be based only in rural areas. FILE PHOTO

was in the State list, and the NCDC (Amendment) Act, 2026, is a “naked intrusion” by the Union government into the powers of the States. “As per International Cooperative Alliance principles, autonomy and independence are basic principles of cooperation along with democratic control. The law, which permits NCDC to directly intervene in the cooperative societies and take their shares openly, violates the basic principles of cooperation and facilitates centralisation of power into the

hands of the Union government,” the SKM’s statement read.

The SKM argued that by directly extending financial aid to cooperative societies, the NCDC would centralise cooperative institutions under the power of the Union government for political dominance over States. “This reflects the authoritarian character of the corporate class fully endorsed by BJP-RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh) combine,” the statement added.

The SKM said the Supreme Court, through an

Trinamool chief claims women being given benefits based on caste and religion, questions BJP govt. linking it to eligibility; CM denies discrimination, says 1.45 crore people received funds

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The disbursement of cash to women under West Bengal’s Annapurna Bhandar scheme has given a handle to the Opposition parties to target the Suvendu Adhikari-led government.

Trinamool Congress chairperson Mamata Banerjee took the opportunity on Monday to target the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) regime in the State. “Before the election, the BJP did not discuss eligibility to receive the money. Will the BJP now decide who is eligible? Why are women not receiving money under the Annapurna scheme? Women are being given benefits based on caste and religion,” the former Chief Minister said.

Women in different parts of the State came out in protests last week alleging that they have been denied benefit of ₹3,000 per month under the scheme. Ms. Banerjee had launched



Women protesting after allegedly failing to receive funds under the Annapurna Bhandar scheme, in Malda on Monday. PTI

a scheme to give cash to women in the State in 2021 named Lakshmir Bhandar and before the change of regime the number of beneficiaries who were receiving a sum of ₹1,500 per month had climbed to 2.2 crore.

On Monday, Ms. Banerjee assured women who have been denied benefits that she will stand by them. “Take down the names of those who are being deprived of Lakshmir Bhandar and Annapurna Bhandar benefits. They

will be contacted. I was with you, I am with you, and I will remain with you,” the Trinamool chairperson said.

Alleging that the BJP government has denied her permission to hold public meetings, Ms. Banerjee also added that those who think she will retire from politics simply because of permission being denied are mistaken. “Our fight will not stop until the BJP itself is forced into political retirement,” she said.

Hours later, Chief Minis-

ter Suvendu Adhikari said that 1.45 crore beneficiaries have been disbursed with Annapurna Bhandar funds.

The Chief Minister tried to defend the fact that beneficiaries of Annapurna Bhandar are being scrutinised and questioned why the scheme was promised to women between 25 years and 60 years of age during the Trinamool regime if it was universal.

Allegations denied

Mr. Adhikari refuted allegations of Muslim being denied benefits under the scheme and said that about 19.20 lakh Muslims have got payments under the scheme. “Those eligible, whether Hindu or Muslim, Trinamool or BJP, have received the benefits,” the Chief Minister said. He said that a portal has been opened where people can lodge complaints for denial of benefits and also complain if anyone who is non-deserving is availing of scheme benefits.

Stalin challenges TVK candidate’s victory in Kolathur

Press Trust of India
CHENNAI

DMK President M. K. Stalin on Monday filed a petition in the Madras High Court, seeking to declare the election of TVK candidate V.S. Babu from the Kolathur Assembly constituency as void and consequently declare him as duly elected from that constituency.

In his petition, Mr. Stalin submitted that after the election was over and results were declared, he had duly nominated senior advocate N.R. Elango as his authorised representative for checking and verification of the burnt memory/microcontroller in the Control Unit, Ballot Unit and VVPAT (Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail) for 14 selected EVM sets pertaining to Kolathur constituency.

During checking and verification by Mr. Elango, grave and alarming irregularities came to light. Mr. Elango immediately wrote to the District Election Officer informing him of these grave lapses.

Without addressing them, the District Election Officer declared that the checking and verification had been carried out successfully and was complet-



DMK chief M.K. Stalin

ed on August 5 in accordance with the prescribed procedures.

On August 6, Mr. Stalin wrote to the District Election Officer highlighting the specific failures that had come to light. He emphasised that the certificates issued by the engineer cannot be, and were not, substitutes for technical/failure reports explaining the causes of the failures.

‘Claim not acceptable’

Mr. Stalin refused to accept the District Election Officer’s claim that the process had been successfully carried out. Therefore, he has filed the present petition, challenging the order of the District Election Officer.

Mr. Stalin also sought a direction to the authorities to conduct 100% counting of VVPAT slips relating to Kolathur Assembly constituency.

Jarange firm on Aug. 29 fast over Maratha quota demand

Press Trust of India
JALNA

Maratha reservation activist Manoj Jarange on Monday said he would begin a hunger strike at Antarwali Sarati in Jalna on August 29 unless the Maharashtra government acted on his demands by August 28.

Mr. Jarange sought reservation for eligible Marathas under the Other Backward Classes category on the basis of Kunbi records, completion of the process of issuing certificates and validity documents, and withdrawal of cases against protesters.

A three-member ministerial delegation urged him to reconsider the agitation. Radhakrishna Vikhe Patil, part of the delegation, said the government would address hurdles within “two or three days” and act against officials found responsible.

SC bans constructions near Rajasthan’s Jojari river to curb pollution

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday banned any construction or development activities within 100 metres of Jojari River in Rajasthan. The court also prohibited hazardous industries within 500 metres of either side of the existing flood line along the river’s flow path.

The decision by a Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta is the latest in a series of interventions made by the apex court to protect the seasonal river, which has faced a barrage of contamination that has affected around two million lives in the water-starved State.

On August 4, the apex

court had suggested that the Rajasthan government prepare a 20-point resolution plan to deal with the issue of contamination in the Jojari, Bandi and Luni rivers in the State.

The Jojari river passes through Jodhpur, the Bandi river flows through Pali, and the Luni river runs through Balotra. The Bandi and Jojari rivers merge with the Luni river near Balotra city.

‘Consider relocation’

The Supreme Court had said that the entire industrial area in Pali was located along the river bank. It had said that the State authorities would have to consider relocating industries away from the river in the long run.

Raise proportionate quantity issue with CWMA, SC tells T.N.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court advised the Tamil Nadu government on Monday to take up its contention that it was yet to be given the “proportionate” quantity of Cauvery water due from Karnataka with the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA).

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath, senior advocate C.S. Vaidyanathan, for Tamil Nadu, submitted that the “Cauvery Water Management Authority is not giving directions to make up the proportionate quantity I (Tamil Nadu) must receive”.

Then Tamil Nadu must raise the issue with the CWMA itself, Justice Nath said, adding that “here the issue was about Karnataka not giving you water at all”.

“As of morning, we have got some water. It was in deficit yesterday,” Mr. Vaidyanathan said.

The shortfall of water as per the *pro rata* formula was 17.414 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft) as of August 23, senior advocate G. Umamathy, for Tamil Nadu, said. “Today, they have about 78 TMC in the reservoirs,” the lawyer said.

Hearing on August 31
The court noted Mr. Vaidyanathan’s submission that the CWMA was meeting on August 25 and the State would raise the issue before the authority. The court sought an updated report and posted the case



The shortfall of water as per the *pro rata* formula was 17.414 tmc ft, T.N. said. FILE PHOTO

for further hearing on August 31.

An affidavit filed by Karnataka in the court recently had submitted that the State was able to overcome the challenges of a distress year and worsening El Nino conditions to ensure the supply of water from its Kabini reservoir due to large inflows following good rainfall.

“The releases from the KRS (Krishna Raja Sagara) and Kabini reservoirs have already been reflected at the inter-State border at Biligundlu,” Karnataka had maintained in the affidavit.

However, Tamil Nadu had filed an additional affidavit in the Supreme Court recently, arguing that Karnataka’s release of water was “never voluntary compliance”.

Previously, on August 3, Tamil Nadu had urged the court to direct the CWMA to issue appropriate directions to Karnataka to make good, on a *pro rata* basis, the shortfall at the inter-State point of Billigundulu for the period from June 1 to August 12.

Denial of nod for U.S. trip an insult to Telangana: Revanth

Move reflects discrimination against State, he says, adds that it was an effort to rob investments from Telangana in favour of Gujarat; the CM denies reports of plan to meet New York Mayor

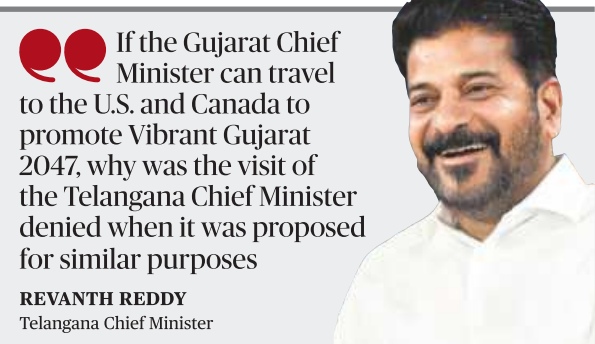
R. Ravikanth Reddy
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Monday termed the Centre’s refusal to grant political clearance for his proposed visit to the U.S. an insult to Telangana.

He alleged that the decision reflected discrimination against the State, and was an effort to rob investments from Telangana in favour of Gujarat.

The Ministry of External Affairs, which had been approached by the State government for clearance for the Chief Minister’s official visit to the U.K. and the U.S., approved only the U.K. leg of the tour.

The MEA cited denial of



If the Gujarat Chief Minister can travel to the U.S. and Canada to promote Vibrant Gujarat 2047, why was the visit of the Telangana Chief Minister denied when it was proposed for similar purposes

REVANTH REDDY
Telangana Chief Minister

clearance from the “political angle”.

Mr. Reddy said the State government had provided detailed information to the Centre about the purpose and objectives of his proposed foreign visit. “If the proposal of a Chief Minister is rejected without properly reviewing the infor-

mation, can such a decision be taken without the knowledge of the Prime Minister,” he asked presspersons here after his return from the U.K. leg of the trip on Monday.

He questioned the Centre’s approach by citing the foreign visits of Gujarat Chief Minister Bhu-

pendra Patel. “If the Gujarat Chief Minister can travel to the U.S. and Canada to promote Vibrant Gujarat 2047, why was the visit of the Telangana Chief Minister denied when it was proposed for similar purposes under Telangana Rising 2047,” he asked.

Rejecting rumours of his scheduled meeting with New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani, Mr. Reddy said no such appointment was fixed. “Mr. Mamdani is not an antisocial element. He is an elected mayor,” the Chief Minister added.

Mr. Reddy said Telangana should not be treated as a lesser State. He added that his government would continue with Telangana Rising 2047 programme.

BJP accuses Karnataka government of ‘double standard’ over Adani Group

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Opposition BJP on Monday accused the Congress government in Karnataka of “double standard”, alleging that it had rolled out the “red carpet” for Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani in the State, while the Congress leadership in Delhi portrayed him as a “BJP agent”.

Leading the BJP protest in the Legislative Assem-

blly, Leader of the Opposition R. Ashok alleged that the government had “surrendered” to Mr. Adani by passing the Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which allows up to 5% of park and garden land to be sold, leased, gifted, exchanged or mortgaged for public utility projects.

Mr. Ashok claimed the amendment was aimed at facilitating the proposed 17.1-km Bengaluru North-

South Twin Tunnel Road, connecting Hebbal with the Central Silk Board Junction, and alleged that the Adani Group was set to execute the project.

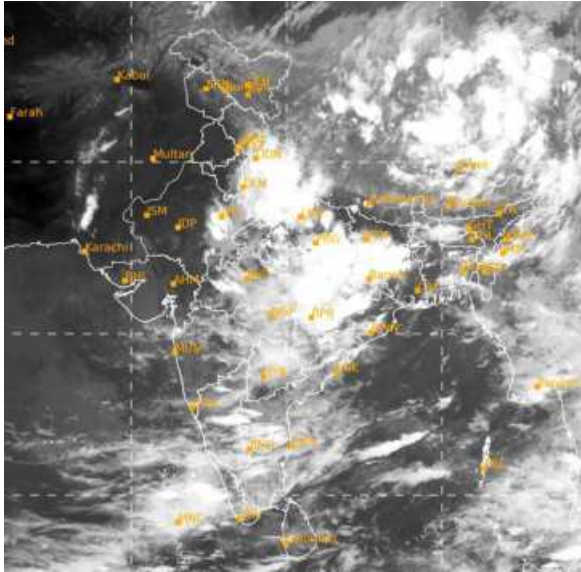
Mr. Adani’s name was repeatedly raised during the BJP’s protest, which was primarily aimed at demanding the resignation of Minister B. Nagendra over his alleged role in the embezzlement of funds in the Maharshi Valmiki Scheduled Tribe Development

Corporation. Speaking to reporters later, Mr. Ashok accused the D.K. Shivakumar government of trying to “take over parks and garden land” in Bengaluru.

Meanwhile, amid the Opposition protests, as many as 10 Bills were tabled and passed by the Karnataka Legislative Assembly and Council without debate, including the Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) (Amendment) Bill.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.6	32.7	25.8	Kurnool	2	32.0	25.2
Ahmedabad	0.2	34.3	26.7	Lucknow	3	33.9	26.4
Aizawl	40	32.0	23.5	Madurai	—	37.0	26.6
Bengaluru	4.1	27.5	20.8	Mangaluru	19.5	27.4	24.1
Bhopal	42	29.3	23.0	Mumbai	9	31.7	25.0
Bhubaneswar	31.5	31.6	25.0	Mysuru	10	29.0	20.0
Chandigarh	31.5	32.0	24.4	New Delhi	3	32.3	27.8
Chennai	31	30.7	26.0	Patna	—	34.5	28.5
Coimbatore	31	32.7	22.4	Port Blair	15	29.4	24.5
Dehradun	—	32.8	24.0	Prayagraj	29.6	32	27.0
Gangtok	0.8	22.8	18.8	Puducherry	—	34.5	25.5
Goa	17	32.0	25.2	Pune	—	28.2	23.7
Guwahati	0.4	34.5	26.7	Raipur	—	82.8	30.0
Hubballi	—	28.0	22.0	Ranchi	14	28.2	23.0
Hyderabad	4.4	25.8	22.9	Shillong	2	25.4	18.4
Imphal	—	30.7	23.5	Shimla	3	28.0	18.8
Jaipur	—	33.8	27.3	Srinagar	—	30	16.4
Kochi	22	27.6	24.0	Thiruvananthapuram	24	31.2	23.4
Kohima	—	26.0	20.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	38.3	28.0
Kolkata	11	31.7	27.5	Vijayawada	—	31.2	26.9
Kozhikode	20	27.3	24.7	Visakhapatnam	3.5	31.7	26.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	8	40	57	51	108	—	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Leh, Ladakh
Bengaluru	24	8	12	85	98	—	recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 187 indicating a moderate level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 12
Chennai	5	8	40	12	149	—	
Delhi	33	41	117	259	226	—	
Hyderabad	12	12	34	37	57	—	
Kolkata	5	29	38	42	82	—	
Lucknow	7	20	33	41	41	—	
Mumbai	10	40	25	23	55	—	
Pune	12	16	74	29	81	—	
Visakhapatnam	18	59	23	34	81	—	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

INBRIEF



Keralam approves SOP for euthanasia of rabid stray dogs

The Keralam government has approved standard operating procedures (SOP) for euthanising rabid, incurably ill or demonstrably dangerous stray dogs. The SOP, approved recently, relies on the Supreme Court’s order in May this year allowing euthanasia in such cases. A stray dog management committee, which will be formed in every local body, will bear the responsibility of deciding whether mercy killing has to be done. The committee, which will have the local body chairperson as its head and the secretary as the convener, will include the respective ward councillor and veterinary officer, among others.

A.P. Home Minister injured as drone battery falls on her

Andhra Pradesh Home Minister Vangalapudi Anitha suffered a minor injury to her right hand when a battery from a low-flying drone fell on her hand while she was on the dais during the inauguration of the State-level ‘Amaravati Championship 2026’ at Tarakarama Grounds of S.V. University in Tirupati on Monday. District Superintendent of Police L. Subbarayudu immediately stepped in to provide first aid to the Minister. She completed her speech with a bandage on her hand.

Panel orders Apple to pay ₹1.09 lakh for faulty iPhone

A District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission in Keralam has ordered Apple and its authorised service centre to pay ₹1.09 lakh to a consumer over several defects found in an iPhone 14 Plus during the warranty period. The order came on a complaint from a Malappuram resident, who bought the phone and charger for ₹92,250 in 2023 for his son’s online classes. The phone got excessively heated up and its camera was faulty. Despite several visits to a service centre, the defects were not resolved, he said.

March for wages



A patient waiting to be shifted to a ward as junior doctors take out a protest rally at King George Hospital in Visakhapatnam on Monday. The agitation entered its 15th day, with protesters demanding the revision of stipends and the removal of disparities in payments. K.R. DEEPAK

Indigenous popcorn maize seed launched

The Hindu Bureau
MUSUNURU (ELURU)

Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan on Monday launched India’s first indigenous, non-genetically modified, high-expansion popcorn maize hybrid seed in Eluru district of Andhra Pradesh, describing it as a significant step towards greater self-reliance in agriculture.

Speaking at a programme organised by Gourmet Popcornica at Musunuru, Mr. Radhakrishnan said India’s agricultural progress would increasingly depend on indigenous technology, innovation and home-grown solutions capable of competing in global markets.

“India has long depended on imported hybrid technology for high-quality popcorn maize, and the

indigenous hybrid will help reduce this dependence and conserve foreign exchange,” he said.

The initiative reflected the spirit of Aatmanirbhar Bharat, bringing together farmers and entrepreneurs to develop an Indian product with global market potential. “A small beginning should lead to a big vision and a big dream,” he said, referring to Gourmet Popcornica’s journey from a home-grown enterprise in Andhra Pradesh to a major popcorn maize processing company. More than 17,500 farmers in eight States are associated with the company, he said.

Andhra Pradesh Governor S. Abdul Nazeer stressed the need for scientists to develop climate-resilient, drought-tolerant and water-efficient crop varieties.

SC asks Centre to consider plea for reduction in NEET-SS cut-off

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday asked the Centre to consider a plea by Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association seeking reduction of cut-off or qualifying percentile for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality seats (NEET-SS) for in-service government doctors.

A Bench headed by Justice P.S. Narasimha heard senior advocate P. Wilson, for the association, on an application seeking directions to the Centre to return 100% of the unfilled in-service seats to the State. The Union government had submitted that out of the 152 seats transferred by the State of Tamil Nadu, approximately 40 seats continued to remain vacant. Mr. Wilson submit-



Supreme Court

ted that the entire 40 in-service seats must be returned to the State, as 111 candidates were awaiting a reduction in the qualifying percentile.

Subsequently, the court turned to the Union government to take a call on whether the qualifying percentile for Super Speciality admissions should be reduced. It posted the case for further hearing on August 31.

The association had

Krishna water only for drinking: panel

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The three-member committee of the Krishna River Management Board (KRMB) that met here on Monday decided to share the water available in the two joint storage facilities – Srisailem and Nagarjuna-sagar – only to meet the drinking water needs of the people of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, and not for irrigation. The decision comes in the wake of El Nino conditions and poor inflow into the dams.

However, no decision was taken on the ratio of water to be availed by the

two member-States. It was decided to meet again on September 4 to decide the water sharing ratio to meet drinking water needs till the next June-July.

The meeting was attended by Member-Secretary of the river board and chairman of the three-member committee, Satish Kamboj and Engineers-in-Chief O.V. Ramesh Babu (Telangana) and K. Narasimha Murthy (Andhra Pradesh).

As of 6 pm on Monday, the storage in Srisailem was 166.7 tmc ft against its full capacity of 215.8 tmc ft and that in Nagarjuna-sagar was 178.3 tmc ft against its full capacity of 312 tmc ft.

Sailor killed in drone strike laid to rest in Keralam

The Hindu Bureau
KASARAGOD

The mortal remains of 26-year-old Merchant Navy sailor Akhil Joyan, who was killed in a Russian drone strike on a cargo vessel off Ukraine coast, were laid to rest in Keralam on Monday, nearly a month after the attack.

The body was flown to Bengaluru and transported by road to his family home, reaching Vellarikundu around noon on August 24. The funeral service was held in the presence of Rajmohan Unnithan, MP, and Kasaragod district panchayat president Sabu Abraham.

Akhil was among 10 people killed when the grain-carrying vessel *Golden Leo* was targeted on July 19.



Invisible actors

The ECI must stop filing of bulk applications for deletion of voters

The Election Commission of India (ECI)’s Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls has seen allegations of bulk filing of applications seeking to delete voters’ names from draft lists using Form 7 in Rajasthan, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and, more recently Uttarakhand. Ground reports by *The Hindu* from Karnataka, Rajasthan and Gujarat noted that these forms were often filed in bulk fraudulently using names of people who were unaware of the filing. In several instances, hundreds of objections were filed under a single person’s name. Form 7 is filed to object to an existing name – or to request its deletion – on the electoral rolls for reasons such as death, shifting, or ineligibility. The ECI’s Booth Level Officer or the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) has to conduct an inquiry on the application and issue a notice to the voter before taking any action. While Booth Level Agents (BLA) of political parties can file up to 10 Form 7s a day, totalling 30, there is no limit on how many forms an individual registered as a voter from the same constituency can submit. To prevent misuse, the ECI has said that if a person files more than five objections, it will trigger a mandatory review by the ERO to ensure the legitimacy of the claims.

The Opposition parties have alleged that the form was being misused through “systemic and coordinated efforts” to delete names of eligible voters and embolden the BJP’s efforts to wrongfully gain electoral advantage. In the case of Uttarakhand, the Congress has alleged that the manner in which the bulk forms were submitted online pointed to “institutional” access being granted to some in the process. These parties have also sent delegations and submitted representations to the ECI. What is important to note is that in most cases, voters were unaware that applications for deletion of their names had been filed at all, leaving it to workers of political parties active in the constituency to bring it to their notice. According to ECI data, for the third phase of the SIR covering 16 States/three Union Territories there are 3,42,409 BLAs of political parties for an electorate of 36,73,87,831 or one BLA for approximately 1,073 voters. These numbers include agents from ruling and Opposition parties. In such a situation, it is incumbent upon the ECI to step in and protect the voting rights of an individual rather than leave it to the grassroot strength of political parties. The ECI should thus take immediate steps to address this concern. Abnormal patterns should be investigated and the process should be monitored, with a uniform, country-wide Standard Operating Procedure, requiring verification of identity and constituency of the objector and the following of due process before any elector is deleted pursuant to a Form 7.

Perfect host

India was successful as a host of badminton World Championships

The 2026 BWF World Championships in New Delhi marked the rise of France as an on-court force and of India as a capable host. Alex Lanier’s triumph in singles, and Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue’s in mixed doubles, were the first golds in France’s history. It was just over three months ago that the European nation finished a worthy runner-up to China in the Thomas Cup, the de facto World Cup in badminton. The Worlds success has established France as a serious contender in a sport otherwise dominated by Asian countries. In fact, Lanier is just the third non-Asian this century – after Spain’s Carolina Marin and Denmark’s Viktor Axelsen – to win the singles gold at the World Championships. The 21-year-old did that at a spruced-up Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, which was in the dock earlier in January when pigeons and monkeys intruded into the arena during the India Open. The massive facelift ensured that the marquee event’s return to India after 17 years would be long remembered. An Se-Young will also go back with happy memories after reclaiming the women’s singles crown from three-time titlist Akane Yamaguchi. The victory extended the 24-year-old reigning Olympic champion’s stellar 2026, during which she has won an Uber Cup gold medal, and the individual and team trophies at the Badminton Asia Championships.

For India, the competition was the 12th straight edition where it secured at least one medal, with Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly bagging a bronze in women’s doubles. The performance is the latest in a series of good outcomes for Indian badminton after an ordinary 2025, where Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty’s World Championships doubles bronze was the best result. This year, Lakshya Sen reached the All England Open final, and Ayush Shetty at the Badminton Asia Championships. P.V. Sindhu’s victory at the Japan Open Super 750 last month was only her second Tour title in the last four years, and there were also triumphs for Satwiksairaj and Chirag at Singapore Open Super 750, and for Devika Sihag, Tanvi Sharma and Ashmita Chaliha at the Super 300 level. Yet, the feeling is unmistakable that India should have done better at a home World Championships, with Lakshya’s second-round defeat to the unheralded American teenager Garret Tan the most disappointing. There is no questioning the 25-year-old’s capability; he is a World Championships bronze medallist, a two-time All England finalist and finished an agonising fourth at the Paris 2024 Olympics. But no Indian men’s singles player has won an elite BWF Super 1000-level title since K. Srikanth in 2017. A swift end to this drought is essential for the overall health of the sport.

On August 20, 2026, the Supreme Court of India delivered its judgment on the Reference made on the correctness of the judgment in *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board vs A. Rajappa (BWSSB)*, 1978, particularly the test for determining whether an activity falls within the definition of “industry” under Section 2(j) of the Industrial Disputes (ID) Act, 1947. A brief history of the Reference. In *State of U.P. vs Jai Bir Singh (2005)*, 5 SCC 1, a five-judge Bench referred the seven-judge Bench decision in *BWSSB* for reconsideration. A seven-judge Bench was constituted and, by order dated January 2, 2017, referred the matter to a nine-judge Bench. By order dated February 16 2026, the nine-Judge Bench framed four questions concerning the correctness of the test in *BWSSB*, the impact of the 1982 Amendment and the Industrial Relations Code (IRC), 2020, whether government welfare activities count as “industrial activities,” and the scope of “sovereign functions” under Section 2(j).

By the time the questions were framed, the IRC, 2020 had been brought into force from November 21, 2025, also repealing the ID Act, 1947. By virtue of this repeal, the Reference had effectively been rendered otiose. Even so, the nine-judge Bench proceeded to hear the matter.

Judges and reactions

Of the nine judges, Justice D. Datta and Justice U. Bhuyan held that “the reference requires no answer”. Justice B.V. Nagarathna found the exercise “unnecessary and only academic in nature”. Justice P.S. Narasimha held that “an authoritative interpretation of the definition industry’ was compelling at the time of the Reference”, but “such a determination has now become unnecessary, with the repeal of the said provision.”.

Importantly, even the opinion written by the Chief Justice of India (CJI) for four judges acknowledges this. Even as it sought to re-formulate the Triple Test laid down by *BWSSB*, it describes its reformulation of the Triple Test as merely “hypothetical”, and expressly states that it will not apply to any pending case. The ID Act has been repealed, and there can be no future cases under it either. Even the reformulated test framed by four judges was prospective and would not alter pending disputes, which would continue to be governed by the *BWSSB* framework, and since the ID Act, 1947 has been repealed, there can be no future cases under it.

The four questions framed on February 16, 2026 concern only Section 2(j) of the ID Act. The interpretation of Section 2(p) of the IRC was not before the Court.

The CJI, writing for four judges, recognises that the IRC “is an independent legislative enactment and must be interpreted on its own terms, having



V. Gopala Gowda

Former Judge of the Supreme Court of India



Maitreyi Krishnan

Practising advocate

The top court’s treatment of *BWSSB* highlights the enduring anxiety over the scope of labour protection

regard to its text, scheme, and object”. At the same time, the same opinion says, in view of the reformulated Triple Test in their opinion, the principles laid down in *BWSSB* shall not be regarded as the “sheet anchor for the interpretation of the IRC should such a question arise in the future”. While on the one hand it refuses to construe a provision, in the same breath it rules on how *BWSSB*, as a precedent, may not be used to construe it. This in itself is a form of construing it, and is an attempt to police the tools available for a future interpretive exercise.

Justice Narasimha also says that it is important to ensure that the interpretation of the definition of “Industry” under the IRC “is not burdened by the existing interpretations” under the ID Act, 1947. Justice Nagarathna’s opinion on this issue is important. While affirming the judgment in *BWSSB*, she recognised that the extent to which its reasoning carries over to the interpretation of “industry” under the IRC is to be tested by comparing the actual text of the two provisions. Such a comparison can be meaningfully undertaken only in a case arising under Section 2(p), and not in the abstract.

The interpretation of the definition of industry under the IRC cannot be seen in abstract and would have to be understood in light of the rich jurisprudence that has developed with *BWSSB* and after.

The importance of *BWSSB*

There is a deeper thread – an anxiety about the judgment in *BWSSB*, which needs to be addressed. This anxiety is what gave rise to the Reference itself. The five-judge Bench in *Jai Bir Singh* (2005) questioned the correctness of *BWSSB*, observing that its “worker-oriented approach” was “unmindful of the interests of the employer or owner of the industry”.

This finds an echo in the CJI’s opinion. Having hypothetically reformulated the tests in *BWSSB*, and having stated that *BWSSB* shall not be regarded as the sheet anchor for the interpretation of the IRC, the opinion of the CJI, for four judges, speaks of the judgment finally lifting a “burden” and permitting the law to “move forward unencumbered”.

This again finds echo in the judgment of Justice Narasimha, who states that the interpretation of the definition of “industry” under the IRC, 2020 “must be freed of the bondage of ratio” in *BWSSB*. In this light, it is essential to recognise what “burden” of *BWSSB* causes such anxiety.

There can be no dispute about the asymmetry between capital and labour, or the imbalance in their respective bargaining power. Justice Bagchi recognises this when he reminds us that one must always “bear in mind that a workman seldom enters the field of negotiation as an

equal....” The Constitution recognises this, with Article 42 requiring the state to secure “just and humane conditions of work,” while Article 23 prohibits “traffic in human beings”, “begar, and other forms of forced labour”. The conditions that necessitated these protections have simply changed form.

Labour legislation recognised this extreme imbalance and sought to ensure a modicum of bare protection. This is not a “pro-worker” understanding of the law, but just a check against the imbalance tilting toward the employer. The fact that such bare protection is described as “pro-worker” says less about the protection than about where the baseline has been unfortunately naturalised. While the freedom to dismiss without explanation is part of the ordinary run of business, a requirement to explain is called a burden. The warning of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar rings true – liberty from the control of the state is another name for “the dictatorship of the private employer”.

The 13-judge Bench decision in *Kesavananda Bharati* (1973) recognised that justice, social, economic and political, formed part of the Constitution’s basic structure. The underlying inequality between employer and workman has not narrowed since 1947. In fact, the policy of “ease of doing business” has widened it. This is exactly why the social justice vision of Part IV of the Constitution calls for more protection now, not less.

The issue of labour rights

The ID Act, 1947 – to maintain industrial peace – provided basic protections and a forum for adjudicating disputes, where the labour courts and tribunals have been given wide powers to adjudicate on the same. To be excluded from its definition of “industry” is to be excluded from that bare minimum protection, and from the remedy available under it. The significance of *BWSSB*’s definition of “industry” lay in ensuring that this protection reached everyone the Act was meant to cover, rather than excluding workers from the one recourse the law offered them.

Given the overarching objective of industrial peace, there was never a reason to treat *BWSSB*’s interpretation as a burden rather than as the Act doing precisely what it was designed to do. The anxiety surrounding it has always rested on the same premise: an eagerness to remove workers from the protection of the law.

As the ID Act stands repealed and the IRC takes its place, it is necessary to return to the promise of social justice in the Constitution. The labour codes that have replaced the ID Act, including the IRC, are built on a premise of exclusion – narrowing who falls within the protection of the law – and will have to answer to that mandate.

The fact is youth unemployment has a household cost

India’s youth unemployment crisis is usually told through a single statistic: how many young people cannot find work. The latest Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS 2025) reports an unemployment rate of 14.8% among 18-29 year-olds, rising to 29.4% among those who are tertiary educated (with a diploma, graduate or post-graduate levels). The broader picture is larger than the unemployment rate alone suggests. Unemployment as a measure captures only those people who are not working but are actively seeking or available for work. It excludes those outside the labour force, including those who may have stopped looking for work, a group that may include many young women. Against the narrower measure of unemployment, the broader picture is considerably larger: 40.1% of tertiary-educated youth are neither in employment, education nor training, commonly referred to as NEET. Among tertiary-educated young women who are NEET, 74.7% are outside the labour force – neither working nor classified as unemployed because they are not seeking or available for work.

A framing that misses another issue

Unemployment is only the most visible part of a wider problem of educated young people remaining outside employment. And for those who are looking for work, the wait can be long. Examination paper leaks, recruitment delays and debates over India’s demographic dividend have kept the spotlight firmly on young jobseekers.

Yet, this framing misses an important question. Unemployment is rarely experienced by individuals alone. Behind every unemployed graduate is often an entire household that financed the degree, adjusted its spending and continues to support a young adult’s job search. Looking at youth unemployment through the household rather than the individual raises a



Gargi Sridharan

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Unemployment among educated youth in India extends beyond jobseekers, placing prolonged financial pressure on families

different question: what happens to families when an educated young adult cannot find work? How households experience that unemployment may depend not only on the absence of work, but also on how long the search lasts and on the resources families have to sustain it.

The households that invested in education

Around 15.4% of Indian households have a tertiary-educated young adult (18-29 years). These are households that have invested in higher education in the expectation that it would provide a pathway to secure employment and upward mobility. Yet, one in five households is supporting at least one unemployed tertiary-educated young adult (20.8%). The household consequences are measurable. Compared to households without any educated unemployed youth, those with unemployed youth spend, on average, ₹1,087 less per month on consumption overall, and ₹710 less per household member.

On average, these households have only 1.5 earning members, compared with two in households without an unemployed educated youth. For 14.4% of them, there is no active earning member at all, while 39.5% depend on a single earner. And in nearly two-thirds (62.5%), no one in the household has a regular salaried job.

The pressure on households becomes more serious when unemployment persists. Nearly three in five (58%) unemployed tertiary-educated youth have been searching for work for more than a year. Close to three in 10 (28.9%) have been unemployed for more than two years. A household supporting an unemployed graduate for a few months faces a different pressure than one financing a job search stretching across one or two years. Extended unemployment depletes savings, reduces consumption, and forces

difficult choices about what employment the young adult should accept.

The data show a clear pattern: the ability to sustain prolonged job search is associated with household earning capacity. For someone in a household surviving on one earner or without a regular salary, the pressure to start earning is likely to arrive much sooner. What looks like the duration of an individual’s unemployment, therefore, is also a measure of how long a family must sustain the wait. These families must push their unemployed youth toward immediate employment, even if it means accepting positions far below their qualifications. The choice is not between a ‘good job’ and ‘bad job.’ It is between ‘any job’ and economic insecurity.

The policy question

Current employment policy largely treats youth joblessness as an individual problem, addressed through apprenticeships, skilling and hiring incentives. The evidence here suggests that the consequences of unemployment extend beyond the individual jobseeker to the household supporting them. The length of the transition from education to work also matters, because someone is financing that wait. Recruitment delays, prolonged selection processes and extended job searches impose very different costs on a household with several earners than on one relying on a single income or without a regular salaried worker. Therefore, employment policy needs to pay greater attention to how long young people remain unemployed, and to the economic circumstances of the families supporting them during that period. Reducing avoidable delays in entry into work is not only a labour-market concern; it can also reduce the strain that prolonged unemployment places on households.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

AI-assisted learning

I write this letter as Professor of Medicine, Sri Ramachandra Medical College and Research Institute, Chennai. While the article, “Beyond the red pen” (EducationPlus, August 24), has laid out well-known aspects of learning using Artificial Intelligence (AI) into a crisp model (PRISM-X), it does not address the practical difficulties a human brain may face when using AI for

learning. The writers have rightly placed prompting efficiency first in the model since the first prompt in a conversation – which some call as the mother prompt – is critical. An AI model’s response is only as good as the prompt. I have observed that AI models are progressively designed in such a way that obtaining a good response requires longer and elaborate prompts. The bottleneck is “Reflective capability” in

learning through AI. Assuming that the user has good prompting skills, handling the AI output is not that easy. Reflective capability requires extensive background knowledge, a deeper understanding of current concepts, and an awareness of misconceptions and future applications. For this, the learner has to spend considerable time reading traditional books, articles and observing real-world

applications. So, it takes considerable time and effort for a person to challenge an AI model, identify misinformation and find wrong concepts put forth by the AI model. This means the world is perhaps stuck at the second stage of PRISM-X – not just students, but teachers as well. I fear that using AI without the skill for “Reflective capability” will, in the long run, erode learners’ thoughts and

make them accept half-truths — something which AI models are very good at. We need to educate students on how to upskill on “Reflective capability” before attempting to implement methods to assess their use of AI.

Dr. Emmanuel Bhaskar,
Chennai

Vacant seats

The report, “Over 13,000 UG seats still up for grabs at

Delhi University” (Inside pages, August 24), is not surprising. The vacant seats mirror the prevailing state of the education system in the country. Education no longer seems to guarantee employment or a livelihood. The National Education Policy needs a complete restructuring.

Balasubramaniam Pavani,
Secunderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Smart glasses highlight gaps in privacy laws

In June, reality star Kylie Jenner posted her latest collaboration on social media – a new design for Meta’s line of AI-powered “smart glasses”. Images of her wearing the glasses filled social media, as did videos of her teenage self lamenting the lack of privacy she was afforded because of her fame. The irony was unmissable: how is Ms. Jenner, who was once so worried about privacy, now promoting a device that enables surveillance?

Smart glasses are the latest addition to the wearable technology space. It is also a dangerous example of how current laws are unable to keep up with today’s tech innovation.

According to Meta, these glasses allow you to see and answer calls, messages, and notifications via voice command. Built-in speakers help you listen to music and an integrated camera enables you to capture photos or videos through the lenses. Meta describes these glasses as “normal-looking eyewear with discreetly integrated glasses technology.” Hidden from the naked eye, these glasses contain “tiny speakers, microphones, [and] a lightweight camera.” The tech giant isn’t shying away from how inconspicuous these features are; rather, it is flaunting it.

Privacy and data concerns
In India, the glasses, which have been advertised everywhere, retail at around ₹25,000. Stickers that claim to completely cover the LED recording indicator are also widely available. Meta says that if the LED is covered, the glasses will block the recording until the sticker is removed. Yet, workarounds are just a Google search away. The glasses also make a shutter sound when they start and stop recording, but this is not a strong indicator that you are being recorded. Further, Meta argues that the glasses are “designed for privacy, controlled by you.” But this “control” is limited to the wearer, and not the recorded



Sonikka Loganathan

As wearable tech becomes more advanced, banning it will become increasingly difficult. Instead, laws should be framed with an understanding of how AI is changing the landscape

subject, such as requiring additional verification before use.

The website adds, “Meta collects data needed to help ensure that your glasses and app are reliable, secure and operating normally.” An investigation by Swedish newspapers *Svenska Dagbladet* and *Goteborgs-Posten* found that Meta’s contracted workers, who sometimes review the data to track user experience, were able to view sensitive content filmed on the smart glasses, including wearers using the toilet. In a comment to *BBC News*, Meta said its privacy policy states that it sometimes uses contractors to review data shared with them.

In this context, concerns about women’s privacy have grown. Data from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) show that in 2023, before the glasses entered the market, there were 3,678 cases of women-centred cybercrimes. Of these, 2,767 cases involved the transmission or publication of sexually explicit material. Consider how much easier these glasses would make it to record people without their knowledge, including in private spaces. The potential risks to children are equally concerning. In 2023, the NCRB recorded over 698 cases related to the use or storage of child sexual abuse material. If adults cannot often recognise when the glasses are recording, a child certainly cannot.

These risks are compounded by the glasses’ battery life, offering 4-9 hours of active use. This means entire movies can be recorded, university lectures can be taped, confidential documents scanned, and patient information collected. It also means that even those who are not intentionally engaging in malpractice could invariably do so – by capturing something private in the frame’s periphery, for example. Ultimately, these glasses allow for the extensive, non-consensual collection of data.

Lacuna in the law
India’s laws today do little to

protect people from this surveillance. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDPA) is technologically agnostic, making the purpose of data collection the key consideration. In a public space, people can neither grant consent nor monitor how their information is used.

Following the landmark *K.S. Puttaswamy vs. Union of India* 2017 judgment, reasonable expectation of privacy was recognised as a fundamental right under Article 21. This means that people, even in public spaces, don’t generally expect to be captured in detail. But the DPDPA excludes information that is made publicly available. Hence, the reasonable expectation of privacy granted by *Puttaswamy* is not met because the Act does not regulate how someone is being recorded in public. The Act’s scope is diluted further since there are minimal indicators that you could be in someone’s frame, unlike someone recording on their phone.

This combination of rapid tech innovation and a lack of legal regulation and public awareness creates the perfect storm. With devices such as these glasses becoming common, people may be collecting information with little knowledge of where the data are being used. Without legal safeguards, digital accountability risks becoming an afterthought.

Banning such devices isn’t practical from a business or tech standpoint. Meta might be the biggest player in this space today, but Google and Reliance are also entering the smart glasses market. As wearable tech becomes more advanced, banning it will become increasingly difficult. Instead, laws should be framed with an understanding of how AI is changing the landscape. There is a need for assessments on how technology will evolve, the risks that may accompany it, and the government’s responsibility in ensuring that citizens are adequately protected.

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People’s Plan 2.0: an ambitious dream

A campaign which decentralised governance in Kerala is planning a comeback

STATE OF PLAY

Tiki Rajwi

On August 16, many of the best-known names linked to an ‘experiment’ that changed the way Kerala thought about democratic decentralisation came together in Thiruvananthapuram to celebrate a birthday. The People’s Plan Campaign (PPC) was turning 30 years old the next day. The conclave, a non-governmental initiative, saw participation from elected representatives, former Ministers and bureaucrats and hundreds of activists who had lovingly nurtured the PPC and gave it direction through the intervening years. But more than a nostalgic anniversary reunion, it was meant to discuss and plan the ‘People’s Plan Campaign 2.0’.

The plan, as explained by Communist Party of India (Marxist) veteran and former Finance Minister T.M. Thomas Isaac, who had been in charge of the PPC when he was a member of the Kerala State Planning Board, included student internships with local bodies and a tech-driven campaign coordinated through an online portal. Opening the August 16 event, K.M. Shaji, Minister for local self-government in the ruling Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government, recalled how successive governments in Kerala had supported the PPC as a process of deepening democracy.

A rich history
The PPC as an idea traces its roots to the ‘Gram Swaraj’ concept of Mahatma Gandhi. It draws strength from the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments, and the enactment of the Kerala Panchayati



Raj Act and the Kerala Municipality Act which institutionalised local governance structures. Kerala officially launched the People’s Plan Campaign on August 17, 1996. At the time, it was run on campaign mode as the concept of participatory planning was new to the people. Grama sabhas and urban ward assemblies were organised across the State in the months that followed. The Left Democratic Front (LDF) government also took the big step of devolving 35%-40% of the Plan outlay to local governments.

The State Planning Board’s Economic Review had noted how the programme marked a major shift by placing local self-governments at the centre of development planning. With its rich history of social reformation through the late 19th and early 20th centuries, the land reforms that transformed the agrarian system, and its high social indicators in literacy and health, Kerala was ideally suited for such an experiment.

Looking back, the programme may not have been a 100% success, but it was also far from a failure. It made participatory democracy deeper and local governments stronger. The ‘Kudumbashree’ scheme in particular grabbed the spotlight on national and international stages. As noted by Mr. Isaac and Richard W. Franke, Professor Emeritus at the Montclair State University,

in their book *People’s Planning – Kerala, Local Democracy and Development*, “from a mere government-led administrative reform, the PPC has made the process of decentralisation an object of mass action and a part of the popular politics.”

Modern challenges
Yet, as an updated 2.0 version is being ambitiously discussed, the challenges are many, such as waning public enthusiasm and low participation in the grama sabhas, especially in urban areas. When compared to the 1990s, attracting the younger generation to such an endeavour in a fast-paced, rapidly urbanising Kerala would prove a ponderous task, but also the most vital one. Government estimates show that 96.43% of Kerala’s population could be living in urban areas by 2036. The People’s Planning 2.0 would then have to factor in many things: centralisation trends in the government, changing aspirations of the people, and the increasing fiscal stress faced by Kerala.

Yet, the spirit of co-operation fostered through programmes such as the PPC remains all the more relevant today. Many of the hurdles faced by local governments in the last 30 years – unemployment, waste disposal, gender justice and issues faced by marginalised sections – persist. Moreover, more demanding problems have emerged: limited income sources, climate change, and an ageing society. In these changed times, local bodies would need to evolve a new political and fiscal culture with stronger public involvement, and elected members with impeccable credentials.

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Hyderabad, adjoining ACs drive Telangana’s record SIR deletions

Just 20 constituencies in and close to the capital city account for half of the State’s deletions

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Srinivasan Ramani
Areena Arora

At the end of the enumeration period of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process in Telangana, the State registered a 21.7% deletion of names from its pre-SIR electoral rolls, the highest in the country so far. **Table 1** shows the percentage of deletions in the major States where the SIR has been undertaken. The draft electoral roll in Telangana will see the addition and re-entry of electors following the corrections period, but even taking that into account, the 21.7% figure is a rather large one. Only Uttar Pradesh with 18.7%, Tamil Nadu with 15.2%, and Gujarat with 14.5% come close to Telangana in the draft-stage deletion rate.

Map 1 shows the deletion rate across Assembly Constituencies (ACs) in the State. In 21 ACs, the deletion rate was a whopping 35% or more, and 19 of these fall in the “Highly Urban” band. Most were in and around the cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad – Musheerabad registered the highest deletion rate in the State at 45.2%, followed by Sanathnagar (44.9%), Malakpet (44.8%), Lal Bahadur Nagar (44.4%), Jubilee Hills (44.1%), Secunderabad Cantonment (42.8%) and Serilingampally (42.7%). **Map 2** shows the 15 constituencies of Hyderabad district. Across the 21 “Highly Urban” constituencies, nearly 70% of those deleted were taken off the rolls because they had “shifted”.

Unlike States such as Bihar, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal, Chhattisgarh and Kerala, which recorded a drop in gender ratio between their 2024 Lok Sabha rolls and their final SIR rolls, Telangana’s draft rolls show a slight increase – the ratio rose from 1,018 in the pre-SIR roll to 1,028 in the draft roll (**Table 2**). Ta-

mil Nadu saw a similar bump, from 1,034 in its 2024 Lok Sabha roll to 1,044 in its final SIR roll. Telangana’s figure, however, is at the draft stage and could still change.

The urban-rural split in terms of deletions was sharp (**Table 2**). In “Highly Urban” constituencies, the deletion rate was 40.4%. In “Moderately Urban” constituencies it was 29.8%, but that figure is driven by the peri-urban belt adjoining Hyderabad rather than by the district towns: Maheswaram (41%) and Rajendranagar (38.9%), both in Rangareddy district, Patancheru (31.9%) in Sangareddy district, and Medchal (31.5%) in Medchal Malkajgiri district all recorded rates at or above the “Highly Urban” range. The urban seats in the same band were lower – Warangal West at 28.9%, Nizamabad (Urban) at 27%, Khammam at 24.6%, and Warangal East at 19.5%.

In contrast, in the “Moderately Rural” and “Highly Rural” constituencies, the deletion rate was much lower – 12.37% and 11.92% respectively. In the former category, again, several of the highest deletion rates are in areas not far from Hyderabad. Among “Highly Rural” constituencies, Achampet (16%), Makthal (15.7%), Mudhole (14.9%), and Yellandu (14.6%) registered the highest deletion rates.

To classify Telangana’s 119 constituencies, night-time light intensity from SHRUG database maintained by Development Data Lab was used. And for each constituency, the average brightness across its area was calculated. Because a few city seats are far brighter than the rest, the values were first converted to a logarithmic scale, then grouped using Jenks Natural Breaks – a standard mapping technique that finds the cut-off points where the data separate most naturally – into “Highly Urban”, “Moderately Urban”, “Moderately Rural” and “Highly Rural”.

More granular analyses will follow in forthcoming articles. (With inputs from Swathi Vadlamudi)

A great purge

Telangana is likely to witness the biggest drop in its electoral rolls compared to other major States if the ongoing ‘Claims and Objections’ phase of the Special Intensive Revision does not bring more voters back onto the rolls



TABLE 1: Share of deleted voters did not change much in most of the major States between draft and final SIR rolls

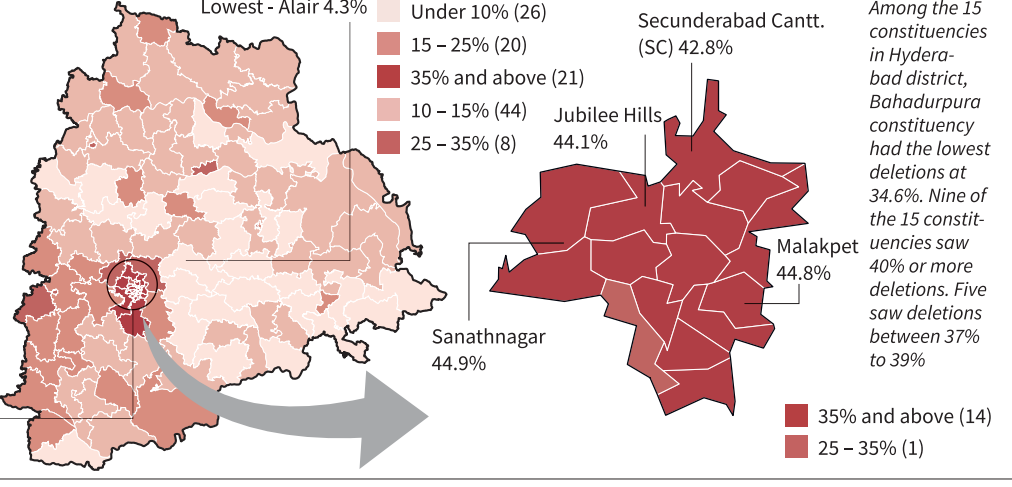
State	Deletions % compared with pre-SIR rolls	
	in draft SIR rolls	in final SIR rolls
Telangana	21.7	-
Uttar Pradesh	18.7	13.2
Tamil Nadu	15.2	11.6
Gujarat	14.5	13.4
Chhattisgarh	12.9	11.8
Kerala	8.7	3.2
Bihar	8.2	6
Rajasthan	7.7	5.7
West Bengal	7.6	8.1
Madhya Pradesh	7.5	6

TABLE 2: Deletions were concentrated in urban areas, with 21 highly urban ACs losing roughly four out of every 10 voters

Measure	Highly Rural	Moderately Rural	Moderately Urban	Highly Urban	All Telangana
Assembly constituencies (ACs)	21	65	12	21	119
Pre-SIR share in electorate (%)	14.02	47.24	13.84	24.89	-
Share in electorate, draft SIR (%)	15.78	52.87	12.40	18.95	-
Female per 1,000 male, pre-SIR	1,044	1,052	996	954	1,018
Female per 1,000 male, draft SIR	1,025	1,038	1,027	1,004	1,028
Deletions	5,65,518	19,77,351	13,96,366	34,00,000	73,39,235
Deletion (%)	11.92	12.37	29.83	40.38	21.7
- shifted (%)	52.28	50.54	61.96	69.38	61.58
- absent (%)	7.58	12.10	20.23	19.50	16.73
- death (%)	25.42	21.18	8.46	7.11	12.57
- duplicate (%)	14.72	16.18	9.34	4.02	9.13

MAP 1:

All the 21 constituencies that saw deletions of 35% or more in the draft SIR rolls were in and around the Hyderabad region



Among the 15 constituencies in Hyderabad district, Bahadurpura constituency had the lowest deletions at 34.6%. Nine of the 15 constituencies saw 40% or more deletions. Five saw deletions between 37% to 39%

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 25, 1976

Dhillon wants sustained road safety campaigns

New Delhi, August 24: Although the standard of public transport has considerably improved sustained campaigns to educate the public about road safety along with regular drives to check over-speeding, violation of traffic regulations and driving under the influence of liquor would greatly help to minimise the rising incidence of road accidents in the country.

This was stated by Dr. G.S. Dhillon, the Union Minister of Shipping and Transport, while inaugurating the 13th meeting of the Transport Development Council here this morning.

Dr. Dhillon said the procedure regarding issue of driving licence and fitness certificate would also need to be tightened so that only competent and experienced persons secured the driving licences and fitness certificate issued to mechanically sound vehicles.

He said it would have a deterrent effect on rash and negligent driving if persons responsible for accidents were to pay compensation to the victims of their families in all cases.

Referring to the national permit scheme for goods transport which aims at removal of hurdles in the free movement of vehicles, Dr. Dhillon said that out of the total number of 5,300 permits allotted in various States, nearly 3,000 permits had been issued in pursuance of this scheme which formed part of the 20-point economic programme of the country.

The Minister also drew the attention of the members to the scheme regarding mechanisation of cycle rickshaws and requested them to strive for its early implementation in order to improve the economic conditions of the rickshaw pullers.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 25, 1926

Imperial bank of India

Calcutta, August 25: The Imperial Bank of India has fulfilled its undertakings to open hundred new branches within five years. The announcement was made yesterday by Mr. H.C. Edmondson, while presiding at the annual general meeting of shareholders on the Calcutta register of the Bank. The burden of opening majority of the new branches, he said, fell on Bengal Circle which opened 66, while seven new sub-agencies and pay offices were also established.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of polling stations in Delhi after the SIR exercise

14,947 The number of polling stations in Delhi has gone up to 14,947 from 13,033 after rationalisation under the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) exercise. The number of polling-station locations has also increased from 2,696 to 2,856, according to a statement by the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) on Monday. PTI

Number of weeks for CPCB to fix standards for 3 new pollutants

10 The National Green Tribunal has allowed the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) 10 weeks to standardise the methods for testing three new parameters or pollutants in ambient air. The three new pollutant in ambient air are aluminium, iron and silica. At present, the CPCB tracks 12 major pollutants under the National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS). PTI

Number of airports to be awarded to private players by the govt.

11 The government plans to award 11 airports, including those at Varanasi and Tirupati, to private players in five bundles under the public-private-partnership model. The Civil Aviation Ministry has proposed the private partners for 11 airports, grouped into five bundles, with each bundle to be awarded to a single concessionaire, according to an official document. PTI

Percentage increase in average retail price of onion year-on-year

59 in per cent. Data maintained by the Centre shows that the all-India average retail price of onion rose 59 per cent year-on-year to ₹43.53/kg on August 24, from ₹ 27.37/kg a year ago. The Centre has started moving bulk onion stocks through dedicated railway rakes – the ‘Kanda Express’ – from Nashik in Maharashtra to major consuming centres. PTI

Bills passed in the Karnataka Legislative Assembly on Monday

8 Eight Bills, including the one allowing portions of park and garden land to be used for public infrastructure and utility projects, were passed by the Karnataka Legislative Assembly on Monday without discussion, amid the Opposition’s protest demanding the resignation of Cabinet Minister B. Nagendra. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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How the SC ruling redefined ‘industry’

The majority held that ‘industry’ under the IRC must be interpreted based on its own specific text and statutory context, unburdened by the legacy of the 1978 precedent; Justices B.V. Nagarathna, Dipankar Datta, and Ujjal Bhuyan formed the minority view that a re-evaluation of the 1978 judgment was ‘unwarranted’

EXPLAINER

Krishnadas Rajagopal

The story so far:

A nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court of India recently held that the nearly half-century-old interpretation of the term ‘industry’ will not automatically apply to the Industrial Relations Code (IRC), 2020, which came into force in November 2025 and replaced the legacy Industrial Disputes Act, 1947. This decision effectively severs the new labour regime from an expansive, worker-friendly precedent set in 1978, establishing a clean slate for future labour law disputes.

The scope of ‘industry’

To understand the significance of this judgment, one must look back to the historic 1978 ruling in *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board v. R. Rajappa*. Authored by Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer, that seven-judge Bench significantly broadened the definition of Section 2(j) under the 1947 Act. The 1978 judgment introduced the triple test, which classified systematic or organised operations based on employer-employee cooperation to provide goods or services for consumers as an industry. This sweeping definition brought various activities, including hospitals, educational institutions, and municipalities, under the legal definition of an industry. The only exclusions were core sovereign functions of the state, such as defence, judiciary, and law enforcement. For nearly half a century, this judgment had enabled workers across diverse sectors to access legal recourse, enforce labour rights, and engage in collective bargaining against unfair practices.

The crux of the judgment

The Constitution Bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, addressed the



Word of caution: Justice B.V. Nagarathna stressed that altering the definition of industry could create uncertainty and disrupt industrial peace. AFP

question whether the 1978 definition of ‘industry’ should govern Section 2(p) of the IRC. The majority held that ‘industry’ under the IRC must be interpreted based on its own specific text and statutory context, unburdened by the legacy of the 1978 precedent. Chief Justice Kant noted that while the core principles of the 1978 ruling had stood the test of time, the 1978 judgment would no longer act as the “sheet anchor” for interpreting ‘industry’ under the IRC. Pending cases under the 1947 Act will continue to be governed by the 1978 Bangalore Water Supply precedent. All future disputes governed by the new Industrial Relations Code will be interpreted afresh.

Differing points of view on the Bench
The nine-judge Bench reflected nuanced positions on the balance between worker

protections and modern economic realities. An opinion authored by Chief Justice Kant, and shared with Justices Satish Chandra Sharma, Alok Aradhe and Vipul M. Pancholi, held that the ‘triple test’ of 1978 Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board case judgment will continue to be applied to pending industrial disputes. The Chief Justice, however, found that the 1978 verdict could have been articulated differently and set down a “reformulated” triple test, which would operate prospectively. However, the possibility of using the recast triple test to determine if an operation was an industry or not under Section 2(j) of the repealed 1947 Act is non-existent as the new labour law, The Industrial Relations Code 2020, has already come into force. The Bench has unanimously made it clear that ‘industry’ under the 2020 Code will be

“interpreted independently” to align with contemporary industrial dynamics, and not be burdened by the 1978 verdict. Justices B.V. Nagarathna, Dipankar Datta, and Ujjal Bhuyan formed the minority view on the Bench that a re-evaluation of the 1978 judgment was “unwarranted”. Justice Nagarathna cautioned that altering the definition could create uncertainty and disrupt industrial peace. Justice Nagarathna argued that the 1978 judgment had offered a broad-based definition of ‘industry’. She highlighted that the judgment was a child of its time, when public sector workers were transitioning into private employment due to a changing industrial landscape inspired by privatisation, liberalisation and globalisation of the Indian economy. Justice Joymalya Bagchi supported the need for the reference to the nine-judge Bench, but expressed his inability to agree to a “reformulated” triple test. Justice Bagchi said an apprehension that the triple test conceived in the 1978 judgment converted any organised activity into an industry was misplaced. The judge agreed with Justice Nagarathna that even the state could enter into seemingly non-sovereign functions. The concept of ‘sovereignty’ has itself undergone changes with the passage of time. Absence of a profit motive did not take an activity outside the realm of industry, he observed. He said it was unwise to “re-draft” Justice Iyer’s triple test. Justice Datta echoed the need for judicial consistency. Sharing his opinion with Justice Bhuyan, Justice Datta remarked that institutional credibility relies on respecting finality rather than perpetuating doubt over established law.

A step towards a new era
By severing the IRC from the 1978 precedent, the Supreme Court has set the stage for a new chapter in Indian labour law, leaving it to future courts to decide where the lines between employer authority and worker protections will ultimately be drawn.

THE GIST

▼ A nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court recently held that the nearly half-century-old interpretation of the term ‘industry’ will not automatically apply to the Industrial Relations Code, 2020. ▼ A 1978 ruling had introduced the triple test, which classified organised operations based on employer-employee cooperation to provide goods or services for consumers as an industry. This judgment had enabled workers across diverse sectors to enforce labour rights.

Did Press Note 3 relaxations help attract more FDI?

The Centre says that 29 FDI projects worth ₹4,895.65 cr. had been reported to it under the revised framework

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan

The story so far

The Union government on Friday said that India had received foreign direct investment (FDI) worth ₹4,895 over just the last few months, from companies that have benefitted from recent relaxations made to India’s FDI rules. The aim of the relaxations was precisely to ease the flow of investments that had earlier been locked out of India. **What was the earlier rule?** The Union government had issued Press Note 3 in April 2020, in which it amended India’s FDI policy. The existing rule at the time stated that any entity of Bangladesh and Pakistan could invest in India only after securing Government approval. Press Note 3 widened this stipulation to

include any country that shared a land border with India. So, this included Pakistan, China, Bangladesh, Nepal, and Bhutan. The popular perception is that the government took this decision as a result of border clashes between India and China at Galwan. However, Press Note 3 was issued in April 2020, before those clashes took place in May. The reason the change was made was to prevent hostile takeovers of companies ailing due to the COVID-19 pandemic. India and a few other countries had noticed that, early on in the pandemic, Chinese companies were buying up majority stakes in companies in the countries whose stock prices had plummeted due to the pandemic. The FDI restriction was aimed at curbing this. While the origin of the rule was not directly linked to the border clashes, its

extension over the years was certainly a result of the frigid relationship between India and China. **What was the relaxation?** In March 2026, the Centre eased the Press Note 3 restrictions somewhat. It said that FDI from entities would be allowed in India through the automatic route, without needing express government approval, if these entities had less than 10% stake based in countries that share a land border with India. In other words, companies that had minority and non-controlling stakes held by these land-border countries could invest in India through the easier route. The government did this because it said that a lot of investment into India had been held up because even companies that had tiny stakes owned by Chinese entities faced stricter restrictions on their investments into India.

“It is expected that the new guidelines will provide clarity and ease of doing business in India, and facilitate investments which can contribute towards greater FDI inflows, access to new technologies, domestic value addition, expansion of domestic firms and integration with global supply chain,” the government had said in March when it eased the rules. **What has been the benefit?** The Ministry of Commerce and Industry said on Friday that a total of 29 FDI projects worth ₹4,895.65 crore had been reported to it under its revised framework up to August 10, 2026. It added that these investments span a range of sectors, including information technology, artificial intelligence, information and communication, manufacturing, pharmaceuticals, data centres and transport services, among others. Further, the investments have come from several countries, including Mauritius, the U.S., the Republic of Korea, Japan, Singapore, Luxembourg, and the Cayman Islands. In relative terms, this investment amount is not all that significant. For instance, it amounts to less than 1% of the total FDI India received in 2025-26. But it is still early days, and for India and FDI, every little bit helps.

THE GIST

▼ The Union government had issued Press Note 3 in April 2020, stipulating that any country sharing a land border with India could invest in the country only after securing Government approval. ▼ In March 2026, the Centre eased the Press Note 3 restrictions somewhat. It said that FDI from entities would be allowed in India through the automatic route, without needing express government approval, if these entities had less than 10% stake based in countries that share a land border with India.

CACHE



Privacy concerns: Protesters have expressed their anger against Flock by blocking cameras, reporting them to DeFlock in order to map them and pressuring clients to end their Flock contracts. REUTERS

What has fuelled the backlash against Flock cameras in U.S.?

Flock, a maker and operator of surveillance cameras and licence plate readers, has come under fire as critics accuse it of surveilling Americans and failing to do enough to curtail the misuse of data, including by some law enforcement officers

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far
The head of Flock, a maker and operator of surveillance cameras, that works with a range of clients in the United States, issued an apology this month after the *Washington Post* reported that multiple law enforcement officers had abused his product network, with at least one case involving an officer who misused Flock to stalk his ex-partner through her car's licence plates.
Across the U.S., anger is mounting against the surveillance camera firm, with critics going so far as to disrupt or even destroy the Flock cameras in their communities.

How do Flock cameras work?
Founded in 2017, Flock developed its business with the help of a two-way strategy: the sale of surveillance hardware, as well as surveillance-as-a-service subscriptions. Flock products include licence plate reader (LPR) cameras, video cameras, mobile security trailers, audio detection devices, drones, and software offerings. Instead of just buying and using a single camera, clients can join the Flock network and enable (optional) law enforcement access.
Due to this strategy, Flock's devices can help police officers collect data across wider areas and with more cameras, to detect incidents ranging from stolen cars to gun shootings.
The company's numbers certainly

impress. According to its 2026 factsheet, over 2,800 crimes were solved weekly with Flock technology, while over 2,000 missing people have been located. Flock reported that it has partnered with over 6,000 "communities" across 49 U.S. states, as well as "thousands" of law enforcement agencies.
What caused the outrage against Flock cameras?
There are a number of reasons uniting the Americans who are against Flock. These range from the company's reputational challenges and the misuse of its Flock cameras, to the general anger over mass surveillance technologies.
Company founder and CEO Garrett Langley made headlines last year when he referred to a critic's anti-Flock advocacy organisation (called DeFlock) as "terroristic." He apologised for his comments this July, and promised to improve on the company's responses to the public's concerns.
Still, the *Washington Post* report in August that covered incidents where police officers misused Flock data to stalk women has added yet more fuel to the fire.
Soon afterwards, Flock announced that it was updating its safeguards, and cutting its default ALPR (Automated Licence Plate Reader) data retention period to seven days, unless legally required to keep the images for longer.
On its "Myths vs Facts" page, Flock noted that it does not carry out facial recognition, predictive policing, or demographic profiling. Flock stated that it

did not contract with the U.S. agency ICE (Immigrations and Customs Enforcement) or the tech firm Palantir, both of which are associated with mass surveillance. Even so, media outlets have identified Flock cameras as being AI-powered. U.S. lawmakers have also raised questions about the possibility of ICE accessing Flock data.
Despite its outreach attempts, Flock is still facing public fury. One reason for this was a May 2025 report which alleged that Texas officials had used thousands of cameras in the Flock network to track down a woman who had an abortion, as part of an investigation. Flock dismissed these reports last year and stated that it was a missing persons case. However, later findings by the Electronic Frontier Foundation (EFF) advocacy group support the original report.
While the verdict was pending, a simplistic version of the events entered the public consciousness: social media users began claiming that Flock had worked with the police to enforce the Texan abortion ban and target a woman.
In recent weeks, protesters have expressed their anger against Flock by blocking cameras, reporting them to DeFlock in order to map them, pressuring clients to end their Flock contracts, or even destroying Flock cameras. For example, a trending Instagram Reel with over 2 million views and 2,69,000 likes taught watchers how to dismantle a Flock camera without being detected by other cameras.
Furthermore, U.S. media outlets reported that in July, the Los Angeles

Police Department (LAPD) would not renew its original contract with Flock, due to "serious concerns" regarding civil liberties, privacy, and the data being collected from the cameras.
Does India face a similar dilemma?
Across Indian cities, more law enforcement bodies are experimenting with AI-powered cameras in order to catch traffic rules violators through their licence plates.
While these automated solutions seem encouraging, there has been a lack of human follow-up when it comes to penalising the offenders. Another challenge is in ensuring that the authorities are handling facial recognition data securely and privately.
Meanwhile, the use of CCTV cameras by both police departments and private citizens is rampant, but these surveillance efforts are fragmented.
Unlike with Flock, it is hard to share private camera feeds with the police in real time and derive useful insights from the data. Since they are owned by everyday users rather than leased by a dedicated company, these surveillance cameras are often unreliable and poorly maintained.
However, Indian citizens have become more vocal in calling out the use of smart glasses and AI-powered surveillance vans by the police, such as during the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) demonstrations in July. The potential misuse of facial recognition data to harass lawful protesters is a serious concern in these instances.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Sean Connery, the working-class Edinburgh boy who became the first actor to portray James Bond on-screen, was born on this day in 1930. A quiz on the Scottish actor

Mohammed Hidhayat

- QUESTION 1**
Before acting, a young Connery represented Scotland in which bodybuilding contest?
- QUESTION 2**
Which 1962 film introduced Sean Connery as James Bond to the world?
- QUESTION 3**
Connery won his only competitive Oscar for playing a tough Chicago cop in which 1987 film?
- QUESTION 4**
Which cause did Connery campaign for consistently, from the 1990s devolution vote through the 2014 referendum?
- QUESTION 5**
The Man Who Would Be King, starring Connery and Michael Caine, opens in British India and features which Indian actor in its cast?



Visual question: A still from Connery's final live-action outing. Name the 2003 film and identify the acclaimed Indian actor on the left.

Questions and answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. This writer became the first physically disabled author to win the Akutagawa Prize. Name the novel which won her the prize and its translator. **Ans: Hunchback by Saou Ichikawa, translated from Japanese by Polly Barton**
2. This novel won the Man Booker International Prize in 2018. Name the novel and the author. **Ans: Flights by Olga Tokarczuk**
3. This elusive Italian novelist writes under a pen name. The last book in her famous quartet series was shortlisted for the International Booker Prize in 2016. Name her, the book and the series. **Ans: Elena Ferrante's The Story of the Lost Child; Neapolitan Quartet or Neapolitan Novels**
4. This author from Kerala has won most of the major literary awards the State has to offer. Name her. **Ans: K.R. Meera**
5. Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak translated short stories of this Bengali author. **Ans: Mahasweta Devi**
Visual: This translator won the 2022 International Booker Prize for her work on a Hindi novel. Name her, the book and its author. **Ans: Daisy Rockwell's translation of Geetanjali Shree's Tomb of Sand**
Early birds: Tamal Biswas| Siddhartha Viswanathan| Neil Lal| Piyali Tulj| Sukdev Shet



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

Is it correct to say "He has good command over English"? (B. Senthil, Madurai)
Careful users of the language would frown on this. They would argue that one can have command over people, but not over language. You can for example say:
"He has total command over his men. They will do whatever he wants them to."
But when it comes to language, they would prefer "of" to "over".
"We are looking for someone who has good command of English."
"Many children in the south have little or no command of Hindi."
"I am told that Prakasham has good command of French."
There is a tendency these days however, even among some native speakers, to say "have good command over English".
The purists may not like this, but as the Americans would put it, that's the way the cookie crumbles.
To be on the safe side, avoid saying "command over English".

Which of the following sentences is correct? "The Government has many problems" or "The Government have many problems"? (D.S.R. Ramaswamy, Bangalore)
Both are acceptable. It depends on how you view the Government. Do you consider the Government to be a single impersonal unit, or do you look upon it as consisting of separate small units? If you view it as a single unit, then you can use a singular verb "The Government has many problems".
If, on the other hand, you view the Government as comprising several different units, then you can use the plural verb "have" – "The Government have many problems".
There are many words in English, which can take either the singular or the plural verb – family, jury, committee, staff, team are just some of the nouns. Here are a few examples.
"The jury was/were beginning to look bored."
"The family was/were planning to move to Australia."

What is the meaning of "ground zero"? (N. Raja Mani, Secunderabad)
This is a term that has been heard quite frequently on CNN. "Ground zero" was originally used to refer to an atomic explosion; it is the site at which an atomic explosion took place. This is how dictionaries define the term: "the point on the surface of the earth or water directly below, directly above, or at which an atomic or hydrogen bomb explodes".
Today the term is used informally to mean a place of rapid development or change; a place of violent activity.
"About ten years ago no one had heard about Vasudeva Nagar. But today it has become the ground zero from which restaurants and designer shops radiate."
The term "ground zero" is also used to mean elementary level; a "starting point". For example,
"Many of my students will be starting at ground zero."
"My boss didn't like the ad campaign. Looks like I have to return to ground zero."
Published in The Hindu on September 25, 2001

Word of the day

Nefarious:

extremely wicked

Synonym: villainous

Usage: *The committee unearthed a nefarious plot to manipulate the election process.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/nefarius

International Phonetic Alphabet: /niˈfeə.i.əs/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

Maharashtra hospital fire: 3 newborns killed

“The hospital was constructed just two years back and then such a fire incident took place. It is absolutely wrong,” the Health Minister said.

Eyewitnesses said that the ward’s fire alarms failed and the automatic water sprinkler system did not activate even as smoke filled the ward.

Yogesh Savarkar, whose eight-day-old child was admitted on the first floor, told *PTI* that he rescued his child on his own and could “see black ashes on the other children in the hospital”. He said security guards and a nurse entered the smoke-filled ward first.

Earlier in the day, Maharashtra Revenue Minister and Guardian Minister for Nagpur and Amravati districts, Chandrashekhar Bawankule, posted on *X* that some children were shifted to the Divisional Referral Service Hospital for treatment of whom one was serious.

(With inputs from *PTI*)

Karnataka SIR: 1.07 cr. names off draft rolls

Unlike the enumeration phase, when Booth Level Officers (BLOs) were instructed to hand over enumeration forms to voters and a family member above the age of 18 could fill them on the voter’s behalf, BLOs, during this stage, can serve notices on anyone available at the address. The notice will also carry a QR code to submit one of the 11 documents online, but the voter alone must appear for the hearing.

This could pose challenges for sections of voters such as senior citizens, single mothers, women in general, labourers and persons with disabilities, among others.

For instance, within Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) limits alone, 40,307 voters are above the age of 85, while 829 are above 100. More than 21,400 voters are persons with disabilities.

More polling stations

Following the enumeration phase, the number of polling stations across Karnataka increased after rationalisation. Each polling station will now have up to and not more than 1,200 voters, and where a polling station had more voters, they were shifted to another polling station within a two-kilometre radius, the CEO said. This has resulted in the addition of 1,873 polling stations across the State.

Voters unable to find their names in their current polling station or booth list have been advised to search using their EPIC details, where the updated polling station will be reflected if rationalisation has taken place. They may also check two polling stations before and after their current one.

Regarding notices on logical discrepancies and unmapped status, EROs have been vested with full powers to take a decision. If aggrieved by an ERO’s decision, a voter can appeal to the DEO/DC within 15 days. If the response remains unsatisfactory, the voter can appeal to the CEO, the final appellate authority, within 30 days of the first appeal.

While the draft electoral rolls were published at 12 p.m. on Monday, people struggled throughout the day to view and download the rolls, particularly the English versions. While voters were able to access the website, after downloading the rolls, files repeatedly threw up errors such as “error” and “file corrupted.”

CRPF officer hurt, homes burnt in Manipur clashes



Amid the unrest, public transport services on NH-2 continued for the third day on Monday. More than 250 passengers, including women and children, left Imphal for Dimapur and Guwahati in five buses and seven vans under foolproof security.

A Manipur government statement said the departures were delayed due to the situation that arose in Senapati district earlier in the day. Adequate security personnel and road-opening parties have been deployed on vulnerable stretches of the highway to ensure free and safe movement of the vehicles.

“However, timely intervention by the government and the public support prevented the situation from escalating further, and the vehicles left for Dimapur and Guwahati at around 1 p.m. Both sides involved have agreed to maintain peace in the area,” the statement read.

About 100 passengers, who started their journey from Guwahati on Sunday, reached Imphal on Monday afternoon. No untoward incidents were reported along the highway during their journey.

Manipur awaits Centre’s decision on Census 2027

Many Meitei, Naga groups demand NRC to be compiled first; govt. sources say review of situation likely in coming days; Manipur HC to hear PIL petition by Kangleipak Students Association today

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Manipur is awaiting a decision from New Delhi regarding the upcoming Census exercise, which remains in limbo in the State amid the demand by several Meitei and Naga civil society groups for a National Register of Citizens (NRC) to be compiled first. With the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India (RG&CCI) yet to spell out the future course of action, a government source said a review of the situation is likely to be held in the coming days.

On Monday, following a Public Interest Litigation (PIL) petition filed by the Kangleipak Students Association, the High Court of Manipur constituted a Special Division Bench of Chief Justice M. Sundar and Justice A. Guneswar Sharma to hear the matter on Tuesday at 2 p.m. In a notification issued on Monday, the court said the Special Division Bench would sit exclusively to hear the petition.

The first phase of the Population Census 2027,



Women take out a rally demanding implementation of a National Register of Citizens before the Census in Manipur on Monday. ANI

House Listing and Housing Census (HLO), is scheduled to be held in Manipur from September 1 to September 30. The training of enumerators has been halted in the State due to opposition and protests by several civil society groups.

The self-enumeration portal was scheduled to go live on August 17, but is yet to become operational.

“A decision from the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) is awaited. The RGI office will assess the situation and there will be some clarity soon,” said a State government official.

Delimitation anxiety

Though the Census is not an exercise to determine

citizenship and counts all individuals irrespective of nationality, there is anxiety among a section of people in Manipur that the next delimitation exercise, which will redraw the boundaries of electoral constituencies, may take into account the latest Census data in a manner that could disadvantage the Meiteis and small tribal communities.

Manipur has three major communities – the Meiteis, the Nagas, and the Kuki-Zo people.

At least 14 civil society groups representing Meiteis, Pangals (Meitei Muslims), and the Kom and Rongmei tribes, among others, are in Delhi to seek

an audience with the Centre. The group also has representation from those displaced from their homes as a result of the ethnic violence between the Kuki and Meitei communities that started on May 3, 2023.

Former Manipur Chief Minister N. Biren Singh, who met Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi last week, said people are apprehensive that the “presence of illegal immigrants in the State has affected demographic imbalance” and that while people are not against the Census, they want the NRC first.

The Congress party on August 20 sought the postponement of the Census exercise in Manipur, citing continuing violence and the displacement of thousands of people.

The Kuki-Zo Council, on the other hand, said that to rebut the “falsehoods and propaganda surrounding our population and demographic status during the Manipur conflict, an impartial Census is essential to establish facts and dispel unfounded claims”.

Doval set to hold border talks with China’s Wang today

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING



Ajit Doval

National Security Adviser Ajit Doval arrived in Beijing on Monday ahead of the 25th round of talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) of India and China on the boundary question.

Mr. Doval will on Tuesday meet with Politburo member and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, his counterpart as SR. He will also call on Chinese Vice-President Han Zheng, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

The Chinese Foreign Ministry said the talks would see “in-depth communication on the boundary question”. “The talks between the Special Representatives... are the main channel for negotiations between China and India on the boundary question, and also an important platform for communication between the two sides on issues of mutual interest,” spokesperson Lin Jian said.

“In August last year, China and India successfully held the 24th round of talks during which the two sides had an in-depth exchange of views on the boundary question and

reached a number of common understandings. During this round of talks, the two sides will continue the in-depth communication on the boundary question in the spirit of the common understandings between leaders of the two countries to jointly keep the border areas peaceful and tranquil.” He said the two sides would also exchange views on bilateral relations and international and regional issues.

The visit comes ahead of next month’s expected trip to India by Chinese President Xi Jinping for the September 12 BRICS Summit, and provides both sides the opportunity to take stock of the relationship.

Ties have gradually normalised following the October 2024 meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Mr. Xi in Kazan, Russia.

Hopes fade for 22 sailors of sunken MV Ocean Winner

Satvasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR



Apart from an oil slick near the vessel's position and two liferafts, no other trace of the vessel or its crew has been found. X/@IN_HQENC

The search and rescue operation for the sunken Panama-flagged bulk carrier in the Bay of Bengal has been expanded to cover a wider area, as hopes of finding the 22 remaining crew members alive diminish with every passing hour.

Despite days-long search operations in the Bay of Bengal, neither the debris of the ill-fated vessel nor any of its 22 missing crew members could be traced, an Indian Coast Guard (ICG) spokesperson said on Monday.

The Indian Navy and the ICG are jointly coordinating the search and rescue operation about 700 km east of Visakhapatnam in the Bay of Bengal.

“On August 22, two Chinese nationals were rescued after a distress call was received from *MV*

Ocean Winner (IMO 9145530), which had sailed with iron ore from Paradip for China on August 20. The vessel sank at a location in the Bay of Bengal where the sea is extremely deep,” said Commandant Amit Uniyal, ICG spokesperson.

According to Commandant Uniyal, apart from an oil slick detected near the reported position of the vessel and two floating liferafts spotted by the Navy’s P-8I maritime reconnaissance aircraft, no other trace of the vessel or its

crew has been found.

He said the search area was being expanded as the operation progressed, with the passage of time making the rescue effort increasingly challenging.

MV Ocean Winner had 24 crew members on board, comprising 20 Chinese nationals, three Myanmar nationals and one Bangladeshi national.

The bulk carrier had an overall length of 225 metres and a beam of 32.26 metres, with a cargo-carrying capacity of around 73,000 tonnes.

Jaishankar calls on Putin in Moscow, discusses ties

Press Trust of India
MOSCOW



Cordial visit: Vladimir Putin and S. Jaishankar during their meeting at the Senate Palace of the Kremlin in Moscow on Monday. PTI

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar on Monday called on Russian President Vladimir Putin, as the two sides discussed bilateral ties and global developments. Mr. Jaishankar, who arrived in Moscow on Sunday, is on a two-day visit to Russia. It comes ahead of Mr. Putin’s expected visit to New Delhi for the BRICS leaders’ summit on September 12-13.

The meeting assumes significance as India and Russia seek to deepen their economic engagement and expand cooperation in a range of areas.

Earlier in the day, the Foreign Minister held talks with Russian First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov on ways to further expand bilateral trade and economic cooperation.

“The India-Russia partnership has consistently

demonstrated resilience and adaptability,” Mr. Jaishankar said at an event which he co-chaired with Mr. Manturov. “Even amidst a complex international landscape, our engagement has continued to deepen, reflecting the mutual interest and confidence that define our bilateral partnership.”

Mr. Jaishankar is also scheduled to meet Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov to exchange views on regional and global issues, the External Affairs

Ministry said in a statement on Saturday.

The visit comes a month after Mr. Jaishankar and Mr. Lavrov met in Manila on July 22 on the sidelines of ASEAN-related ministerial meetings, where they reviewed bilateral relations and exchanged views on the Ukraine conflict and the situation in West Asia. Mr. Jaishankar had also reiterated India’s “strong concern” regarding the safety of Indian seafarers in the region during his last meeting with Mr. Lavrov.

Trinamool MP moves SC alleging eviction from govt. residence

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra made an urgent oral mentioning before the Chief Justice of India’s Bench on Monday alleging that the Nadia district administration in West Bengal has evicted her from her constituency accommodation in the dead of the night. Ms. Moitra is the MP from Krishnanagar Lok Sabha constituency in Nadia district.

Ms. Moitra said that on August 14 she was directed by the district administration to vacate the Circuit House in Nadia late in the evening. In a video message, Ms. Moitra stated that as an MP of the district, she was entitled to a stay at the Circuit House and she was

Mahua Moitra’s counsel said that the eviction by local officials was a direct attack on federalism

not vacating it. In her messages, Ms. Moitra repeatedly claimed that a crowd had gathered outside the Circuit House chanting ‘Jai Shri Ram’.

The counsel said the eviction of a sitting MP from her accommodation by local officials, who took the law into their hands, was a direct attack on federalism in violation of court orders.

The counsel argued that the eviction took place despite a High Court order in her favour. The court said it would look into her plea for early listing.

Polls are held under audit of parties and candidates: CEC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Elections in India are conducted transparently under the concurrent audit of political parties, candidates or their representatives at all stages, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar said on Monday. He was speaking at the second regional conference on ‘Electoral Literacy Clubs (ELC 2.0) and ECINET’ in Lucknow which focuses on strengthening electoral literacy and democratic awareness among young citizens through educational institutions.

Addressing the participants, comprising students and teachers from institutions across Uttar Pradesh, he said that elections in India are held strictly as per the Constitution, law and



Gyanesh Kumar

instructions issued by the Election Commission (EC) and are conducted transparently under the concurrent audit of political parties, candidates or their representatives.

Describing students as the future of the nation, the CEC said the ELCs are imperative to carry forth the knowledge and understanding of electoral processes and enrich democracy. He underlined the need for students and young electors to get fami-

liarised with India’s electoral system, democratic values, electoral registration, polling and counting processes, and the role and functioning of the EC.

ELC 2.0, with the tagline, “Learn Democracy. Lead Democracy”, reinforces the objective of encouraging young and first-time voters not only to understand democracy but also to participate meaningfully and contribute to its progress, an official statement by the EC said.

It said that the initiative assumes significance in view of India’s extensive educational ecosystem.

As part of the two-day conference, Mr. Kumar will hold an interaction with Booth Level Officers (BLOs) of Uttar Pradesh on Tuesday. Assembly election is scheduled in Uttar Pradesh early next year.

‘3 Bambiha gangsters deported from Malaysia’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The office of the Minister of Home Affairs said on Monday that three fugitive gangsters linked to the Bambiha Gang, wanted for multiple crimes, were deported from Malaysia.

Indian agencies have facilitated the deportation of 51 hardened criminals in 2026 alone, it said.

In a post on *X*, it said, “Indian agencies got three gangsters apprehended in Malaysia... the fugitives, namely Jaspreet Singh, Ajay Singh and Pawandeep Singh, are linked to Bambiha Gang and are accused of multiple crimes, including extortion, cross-border arms and narco-trafficking, and a foiled grenade attack in Ludhiana.”

Congress targets Modi govt. on price rise and unemployment

The party flags rising prices of food items, including sugar, onions, and milk; party president Mallikarjun Kharge points out that graduates account for 67% of unemployed Indians aged 20 to 29; he slams govt. for absence of jobs after graduation

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday targeted the Narendra Modi government over unemployment and price rise, with party president Mallikarjun Kharge accusing the government of “completely ravaging” young India’s entire pathway from education to employment.

Mr. Kharge cited a recent NITI Aayog report estimating that 8.7 crore Indians in the 15-29 age group were not studying, working, or receiving training. Youth unemployment stood at 15.6%, rising to 19.5% among young women, he said, citing the Periodic Labour Force Survey for July.

“Where are the jobs after graduation,” Mr. Kharge asked in a post on the so-



Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge accuses the government of putting the youth’s future at risk. FILE PHOTO

cial media platform X, pointing out that graduates account for 67% of unemployed Indians aged 20 to 29. He questioned the promise of creating two crore jobs every year, saying that by that calculation, 24 crore jobs should have been created in 12 years.

Mr. Kharge alleged that lakhs of government posts

remained vacant, while secure employment was increasingly being replaced by contractual and part-time work. “Expensive and inadequate education, paper leaks, delayed recruitment, a widening skills gap, and disappearing quality jobs have put the future of an entire generation at risk,” he said.

“You, Modi*ji*, promised to achieve what previous governments could not do in 70 years! You have certainly delivered on that boast: an education system that costs more, infested with RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh), examinations young Indians cannot trust, and degrees that increasingly come without jobs,” the Congress chief said.

The NITI Aayog report, “Reimagining skilling for Viksit Bharat@2047”, based on data from the 78th round of the National Sample Survey conducted in 2021, has called for subsidised training programmes to encourage self-employment, and align skills with local demand and emerging sectors.

The Congress also attacked the government over the rising prices of es-

sential commodities. The party’s communications chief, Jairam Ramesh, cited a media report on a sharp rise in onion prices, saying prices in Nashik had increased by around 76% in a month, while wholesale rates had doubled in some States.

“After sugar, now onions too are slipping out of the common man’s reach,” Mr. Ramesh said on X. The government’s buffer stock was empty, he said, adding that the rising prices of milk, oil, fruits, and other essential commodities were adding to the burden on households.

“The Modi government, which claims to have ushered in *achche din* (good days), should explain how the poor and middle class were expected to make ends meet,” Mr. Ramesh said.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday accused the Narendra Modi government of seeking to undermine reservation through what it termed a “back door” route, citing more than 8.2 lakh sanctioned posts lying vacant across civilian Central government establishments.

The figures showed that the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government’s policy of “conspiring to end” the constitutional rights of disadvantaged communities had been exposed, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said.

The charge came amid the ongoing “reservation *hatao*” (remove reservation) campaign, seeking to end caste-based reservations in government jobs and educational institutions.

Sharing a Ministry-wise

Over 8.2 lakh sanctioned posts are lying vacant across civilian Central govt. establishments

breakup of the vacancies on social media platform X, Mr. Kharge said the number had risen from 4.21 lakh in 2015 to 8.24 lakh in 2024.

According to the figures cited by him, the Railways had 2.40 lakh vacant posts, while the Defence Ministry had 2.41 lakh vacancies. The Home Ministry had another 1.10 lakh vacant posts, Mr. Kharge said.

He also alleged that 5.1 lakh permanent jobs had been eliminated in public sector undertakings, while the share of contractual workers had increased from 19% to 49%.

“The question is not just about employment, but

about social justice,” Mr. Kharge said. He argued that keeping government posts vacant would effectively deny reserved-category candidates opportunities, while the sale of PSUs and increasing contractual employment would further shrink the availability of jobs covered by reservation.

“To end reservations, it is not necessary to amend the Constitution – just eliminating jobs with reservations is enough,” he said.

The Congress president alleged that the BJP’s approach was aimed at weakening the constitutional safeguards for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, and Economically Weaker Sections.

The Congress has sought to frame vacancies and changes in public employment as part of a wider question of social justice.

‘Standard practice’ followed, say officials on U.S. envoy remarks

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Indian officials followed the “standard practice” of checking the modalities for public appearances by Prime Minister Narendra Modi ahead of his meeting with U.S. President Donald Trump on the sidelines of the G7 summit in France earlier this year, official sources said on Monday.

This comes hours after U.S. Ambassador Sergio Gor claimed that the External Affairs Ministry had asked for the press event not to feature questions. Mr. Gor went on to say that Mr. Trump subsequently forgot about the purported request and went on to answer questions from journalists for 45 minutes.

“Discussions regarding arrangements for public appearances of leaders are normal practice ahead of any VVIP visit. In this regard, the Indian side communicated its standard practice for such visits,” a source said, referring to the interaction between Mr. Modi and Mr. Trump in Evian, France, on June 17, 2026.

Addressing a media conclave on Sunday, Mr. Gor had said that the Ministry had an “ask” regarding

making the meeting between the two leaders free of questions from the press.

‘Went over topics’

“We were behind the scenes, behind the stage, and at one point, it was just the President and I, and he asked me what the Indians were going to raise. We went over some topics,” said Mr. Gor.

According to Mr. Gor, Mr. Trump also wanted to know if the Indian delegation had any specific requests regarding the conduct of the event and he was told that the Indian side would prefer not to take questions.

“He said, ‘Do they have any asks?’ And the MEA had one ask,” Mr. Gor said. Mr. Trump, however, forgot about the Indian side’s “ask”, Mr. Gor claimed, and proceeded to answer questions.

“A 45-minute press conference followed, and everything was on the table,” he said.

Official sources, however, pointed out that during the press interaction, all questions, both from U.S. and Indian presspersons, were aimed at Mr. Trump and that Mr. Modi was not asked any questions.

Opposition raises concerns over ‘weakening’ of ISRO; Centre hits back

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The government and the Opposition sparred on Monday over the future of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), with Congress general secretary (communication) Jairam Ramesh raising concern over a reported privatisation push in the space sector, and Union Minister of State for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh asserting that the country’s space programme was being “scaled up”, not scaled back.

Reports about ISRO’s future role had raised “legitimate concerns”, given the capabilities built by the organisation over six decades under scientists, including Vikram Sarabhai, Satish Dhawan, Brahm Prakash, U.R. Rao, and A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, Mr. Ramesh said.

ISRO’s role in rocket development and manufacturing could be “severely limited”, he alleged, adding that a substantial part of its satellite-related assets could be transferred to private companies. He questioned the reported plan to hand over the second spaceport being developed at Kulasekarapattinam in Tamil Nadu, for



Union Minister of State for S&T Jitendra Singh says ISRO is focusing on frontier missions such as Gaganyaan. FILE PHOTO

which ISRO is investing about ₹1,000 crore, to a private company.

“The future of the historic Sriharikota spaceport in Andhra Pradesh is itself anybody’s guess,” Mr. Ramesh said, questioning what he described as an attempt to “strangulate and emasculate” ISRO.

He acknowledged that space start-ups deserved encouragement, and said ISRO had maintained productive partnerships with the private sector. He also claimed that 100-120 key ISRO professionals had left the organisation in recent months, “perhaps seeing the writing on the wall”.

Responding to Mr. Ramesh, Dr. Singh accused the Congress leader of being determined to “run down every Indian

achievement”, and said the facts showed that India’s space programme was expanding through a wider ecosystem involving ISRO, industry, and space start-ups.

Frontier missions

“ISRO is not being weakened. It is being enabled to concentrate increasingly on the frontier missions – Gaganyaan, Chandrayaan-4, the Bharatiya Antariksh Station, and future missions to the moon, Venus and Mars,” the Minister said.

As India targets 50 launches a year, industry would have to emerge as the manufacturer at scale while ISRO focused on developing next-generation technologies and missions, Dr. Singh said. He de-

scribed this as the “natural evolution” of the space programme.

Citing the expansion of private participation, he said India now has more than 440 space start-ups, and referred to the July 18 launch of Skyroot Aerospace’s Vikram-1, which he said was the first privately developed Indian rocket to reach orbit. “That is not ISRO’s legacy being diluted. That is ISRO’s legacy bearing fruit,” Dr. Singh said.

The government was targeting a \$44-billion space economy, requiring private rocket factories, satellite manufacturing facilities, and a deeper supply chain, alongside ISRO’s research and frontier missions, he said.

Sriharikota would remain central to major programmes, including PSLV, LVM3 and human spaceflight, while Kulasekarapattinam would add capacity for the growing small-launch sector, he said.

Dr. Singh also cited the increase in foreign satellites launched by ISRO from 35 before 2014 to more than 430, and Chandrayaan-3’s successful landing near the Moon’s south polar region, to highlight what he described as the results of the government’s space strategy.

Cong. seeks probe into death of tribal children in M.P., Maharashtra

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday sought a special committee to probe the deaths of tribal children allegedly due to malnutrition in Madhya Pradesh and of tribal girls following snakebite in Maharashtra and demanded action against officials found responsible.

Adivasi Congress chief Vikrant Bhuria also called for a safety audit of tribal hostels, citing alleged lapses in facilities in the two States.

Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Bhuria claimed that 22 children from the Baiga tribal community had died of malnutrition and related diseases in the Balaghat district of Madhya Pradesh.

He alleged that a nutritional meal delivered to households had been discontinued for six months. “I had asked in the Madhya Pradesh Legislative Assembly how much budget



Vikrant Bhuria

was allocated for preventing malnutrition in the State’s tribal blocks and projects from 2020 to 2025, and how much of it was spent... The government said malnourished children are given a nutritional meal worth only ₹12 per day,” he said.

Turning to Maharashtra, he alleged that more than 70 girls at a tribal hostel in Gadchiroli were made to sleep on the floor in a single room. Six girls were hospitalised following a snakebite incident, of whom three died, he said.

PM taking forward Sant Ravidas’s ideals of social harmony: BJP president

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Monday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s leadership was taking forward Sant Ravidas’s ideals of social harmony, equality and selfless service, with development reaching the poorest of the poor. He was speaking at the party’s *Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan* (Social Harmony Pledge Campaign) event, organised to mark the 650th birth anniversary of Sant Shiromani Ravidas, a Bhakti poet, who fought for the marginalised sections of society.

Mr. Nabin said that under the Modi government, development schemes were being delivered to the poor. About 25 crore people had been brought out of poverty, he said. He said the BJP’s resolve

was to unite every section of society and realise the goal of a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Among those present were Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, BJP State president and Union Minister of State Harsh Malhotra.

‘Land of saints’

Addressing the gathering, Mr. Nabin said the party’s entire cadre was carrying forward the campaign. Noting that India is a land of saints and penance, he said: “Whenever inequality has arisen in this country, whenever this country has faced calamity, and whenever there has been an opportunity to bring the country out of that calamity, the nation has received the blessings of saints.” He said Sant Ravidas’s ideas helped preserve Indian society and Sanatan traditions.

BHARATIYA RESERVE BANK NOTE MUDRAN PRIVATE LIMITED
(WHOLLY OWNED SUBSIDIARY OF RESERVE BANK OF INDIA)
Note Mudran Nagar, Mysuru - 570 003, Karnataka, India
Tel: +91 821 2582905/15/25, Fax: +91 821 2582099

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING (NCB) / OPEN TENDER ENQUIRY (OTE)
BRBNMPL invites bids under two-bid systems from eligible bidders for following e-tender through MSTC portal:

1. Tender No. 021/MYS/MMD/2026-27, MSTC EVENT No. BRBNMPL/Mysuru Press/MMD/22/26-27/ET/45 [IP-PBX SYSTEM] - Design, Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Performance Testing and Non-Comprehensive AMC of IP-PBX System (with Buy Back) at BRBNMPL, Mysuru.

Last date and time of tender submission is on or before 25/09/2026 by 11:00 AM. For downloading tender documents, and other details, kindly visit our website **www.brbnmpl.co.in** and **www.mstcecommerce.com**. Any modification will be notified on above websites only.

Sr. General Manager

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, BALANGIR (R&B) CIRCLE, BALANGIR
e-Procurement Notice - BID IDENTIFICATION No.CCE(R&B)BGR/05/2026-27
Letter No.2438 // Dtd.21.08.2026

The Chief Construction Engineer, Balangir (R&B) Circle, Balangir on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** for the construction of works detailed in the table below from **"A" & "B" Class Contractor** registered with the State Governments and contractors of equivalent Grade/ Class registered with Central Government/ MES/ Railways for execution of Civil works. The proof of registration from the appropriate authority shall be enclosed along with the bid.

1.Nature of Work : **Building Work**

2.No. of tender : **Total Works - 3 No.**

3.Tender Cost : **Rs.10,000/-**

4.Class of Contractor : **"A" & "B" Class**

5.Date & Time of sale & Receipt of Bids : **From Dt.02.09.2026, 06.55 P.M. to Dt.17.09.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.**

6.Date of Opening of Bid : **Dt.18.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M.**

7.The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website:**http://tendersorissa.gov.in**. All future corrigendum will be available on ONLINE MODE only.

Chief Construction Engineer, Balangir (R&B) Circle, Balangir.
34001/691/2627
OIPR-34001/34131/1/26-27/0012

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No. PT-E-26-014
On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Sl.No	Brief Name of work	Value (Rs)
1	Annual maintenance contract for CMG electrical installations at different zones of SDSC SHAR for a duration of two years (2026-28)	133.40 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) upto **08/09/2026 14:30 hrs**. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website **https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html** and tender free view at **https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro**
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

Rajasthan University of Veterinary and Animal Science (Jobner), Jaipur
Estate Office

क्रमांक :- EO/RUVAS/2026-27/165
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 11/2026-27
दिनांक :- 17/08/2026

राजस्थान पशु चिकित्सा एवं पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, (जोबनेर), जयपुर की ओर से राज्य / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संतर्गत / विभागों में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से आनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
निविदा से संबंधित अन्य आवश्यक विवरण वेबसाइट **http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in**, **http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in** व **https://ruvasjaipur.rajjasthan.gov.in** पर देखी जा सकती है।

Sr. No.	Name of Work	NIT Amount (In Lacs)	Contract Period	Tender Fee	EMD (2%)	Processing Fee
1	Building Work for Centre of Excellence & Rajasthan Institute of Veterinary Science at PGIVER Campus, Jaipur.	915.00 Lacs	18 Months	5000/-	18300000/-	2500/-

1. धरोहर राशि, निविदा शुल्क एवं प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क, संघदा अधिकारी राज. पशु चिकित्सा एवं पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, (जोबनेर), जयपुर के खाते में जमा करायानी है।

Bank Name	ICICI BANK
BRANCH NAME	RHB MANSAROVER, JAIPUR.
ACCOUNT NO.	677601702188
ACCOUNT HOLDER NAME	Estate Officer Rajasthan University of V and A Sciences Jobner Jaipur
IFSC CODE	ICIC0006776

2. निविदा प्रत्यक्ष / दस्तावेज दिनांक 17.08.2026 से दिनांक 09.09.2026 तक रात 6:00 बजे तक वेबसाइट **http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in** पर देखी जा सकती तथा निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 10.09.2026 को प्रातः 11:30 बजे खोली जावेगी।
3. प्रसारित निविदा के सम्बन्ध में किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी Estate Office RUVAS, (Jobner) Mansarovar, Jaipur कार्यालय से कार्यदिवस एवं कार्यालय समय में प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
UBN No. : RVJ2627/WLOB000025
राज.संघदा/सी/26/10427

संघदा अधिकारी
रुवास (जोबनेर) जयपुर

A BM-BME

A RM-RME

INBRIEF



SEBI unveils index for market infrastructure institutions

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has introduced an Information Technology Resilience Index (ITRI) for market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges and depositories, as part of efforts to strengthen the resilience of their IT systems. In a circular, the markets regulator said the index would assess the MIIs across nine parameters, including availability, security, integrity, governance, reliability and monitoring, business continuity, modularity and flexibility, scalability, and other relevant factors. SEBI said that the MIIs would be required to develop an Early Warning System (EWS) to detect any deterioration in ITRI parameters that could potentially lead to performance issues, system slowness or other disruptions, and take remedial measures.

Third Wave Coffee raises ₹408 crore in funding

Third Wave Coffee, a Bengaluru-based coffee and food firm, has raised ₹408 crore in a funding round led by existing investor WestBridge Capital while the round also witnessed participation from Creagis and other angel investors. The new funding is expected to fuel Third Wave Coffee's next phase of expansion, with capital directed towards geographic growth in existing markets, building greater density in high-potential cities and strengthening the brand's ability to serve a wider range of consumer occasions, according to the company. Third Wave Coffee has accelerated its national footprint by entering Ahmedabad, Mangalore and Agra last year while strengthening its presence across Delhi, NCR, Hyderabad, Chennai, Mumbai and Pune. In June 2026, it entered East India with three cafés in Kolkata. The firm is currently evaluating opportunities in other eastern markets, including Guwahati, Ranchi, Patna and Bhubaneswar.

Haryana: Godrej to invest ₹20,000 crore

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Godrej Industries Group is eyeing up to ₹20,000 crore investment in the State of Haryana generating almost 40,000 jobs.

It signed a memorandum of understanding with the State government under which the firm would build upon about ₹12,000 crore it had already invested till date.

Godrej Properties Ltd (GPL) is expected to be a key driver of the Group's expansion, with plans to invest ₹16,000 crore in Haryana by FY28.

GPL currently has 18 projects across Gurugram, Sonipat, Faridabad, Panipat and Kurukshetra. Its future expansion plans are expected to extend beyond residential development.



Godrej Properties Ltd (GPL) will be the key driver of expansion.

Godrej Ventures, the Group's real estate private equity arm, has invested about ₹1,000 crore in the State so far and plans to deploy an additional ₹3,500 crore towards Grade A+ office infrastructure in Gurugram. The office investments alone is likely to generate over 30,000 direct and indirect jobs, Pirojsha Godrej, Chairperson, Godrej Industries Group said.

ALLEN eyes ₹3,800-crore IPO to fund institute's expansion

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

ALLEN Career Institute, a 38-year-old test-preparation firm, is gearing up for major expansion across India, backed by technology investments, selective acquisitions and a proposed initial public offering (IPO) of about ₹3,800 crore.

The Kota-based education firm, which has grown from a family-run coaching institute into a professionally-managed, technology-enabled education business, is looking to use the IPO proceeds to accelerate regional expansion and strengthen technology, artificial intelligence (AI) and



Allen opens Mangaluru Centre.

automation capabilities.

Organic/inorganic route The firm is also evaluating expansion into additional markets through a combination of organic growth and selective acquisitions,

In-principle nod for airports' privatisation

Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee approves proposal for third round of privatisation covering 11 airports in five bundles

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The government's Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) has given in-principle approval to the Ministry of Civil Aviation's proposal for the third round of airport privatisation, covering 11 airports across five bundles, according to a government document.

The proposal will now move towards securing the PPPAC's final approval, following which it will be placed before the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA).

The 11 airports being considered for privatisation in five bundles include Amritsar and Kangra; Varanasi, Gaya and Kushinagar; Bhubaneswar and Hubballi; Raipur and Aurangabad; and Tiruchirappalli and Tirupati.



The airports being considered for privatisation include Amritsar and Kangra; and Tiruchirappalli and Tirupati. FILE PHOTO

Responding to the PPPAC Chair's concern over the risks of oligopolistic concentration and over-leveraging in the airport sector, the Ministry of Civil Aviation said it plans to cap the number of airport bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder.

The modalities for the proposed cap are being finalised and will be submitted as part of the proposal seeking the PPPAC's final recommendation, according to the Record of Discus-

sion dated August 20.

The issue of bidder concentration gained prominence following the previous round of airport privatisation, in which the Adani Group won bids for all six airports on offer.

At the time, the PPPAC had rejected key recommendations from the Finance Ministry and NITI Aayog, including a limit of two airports per bidder and requirement for prior airport operations and management experience.

Domestic sugar prices fall, volatility remains a concern

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE/NEW DELHI

With the Centre's announcement last week permitting import of 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar, domestic prices are cooling down. However, the price volatility remains a matter of concern.

The current sugar marketing season that began

on October 1 last year saw a substantial quantity of sugar sold at ₹38-39 a kg (ex-mill price).

Prices started going up in January, to ₹48 a kg, and stood at ₹56 a kg on Monday (Maharashtra ex-mill price).

The price was ₹58 a kg (Maharashtra ex-mill) on August 22 and ₹62 a kg on August 21.

An industry source said the ex-mill prices are likely to hover between ₹50 and ₹60 till Nov. - December.

Office-bearers of the Indian Sugar & Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) told reporters in New Delhi on Monday that the recent firmness in sugar prices should not be construed as shortage of sugar in the country.

UPI turns a decade-old, sees 13,000-fold surge in transaction volume

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI), launched on August 25, 2016 by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), has completed 10 years of transforming digital payments in India.

UPI has emerged as the backbone of India's digital payments ecosystem and a critical driver of financial inclusion, the Finance Ministry said in a release.

Over the decade, UPI's annual transaction volume expanded from 1.78 crore transactions in FY17 to over 24,162 crore transactions in FY26, representing a 13,000-fold surge in transaction volume.

Transaction value rose sharply from ₹0.07 lakh crore in FY17 to approximately ₹314 lakh crore in FY26, translating into a more than 4,000-fold increase in transaction value, the Ministry said.

UPI is currently opera-



Annual transaction volume expanded from 1.78 crore in FY17 to 24,162 crore in FY26.

tional in 11 countries and has emerged as one of the most successful pillars of digital public infrastructure, providing an interoperable, real-time payments platform that enables seamless peer-to-peer and peer-to-merchant transactions via a single application. "By bridging the digital divide, advancing financial inclusion, and expanding access to digital financial services, UPI has empowered individuals and communities across the country while driving broad-based economic participation," it added.

TCS to buy out Porsche's MHP for €320 mn EV

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is planning to fully acquire MHP Management-und IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), Porsche AG's Germany-based management and IT consulting subsidiary, for an enterprise value of €320 million, excluding customary post-closing adjustments for net debt and working capital.

The acquisition is part of a broader €1.25 billion, five-year strategic partnership between TCS and Porsche under which TCS will provide artificial intelligence (AI) services across Porsche's mobility value chain. The transaction and partnership remain subject to regulatory approvals, with the acquisition to be completed through a TCS subsidiary.

TCS will establish a dedicated AI Mobility Centre of Excellence for Porsche. The centre will focus on deploying AI-driven solutions across manufacturing, engineering, operations and customer experience.

MHP reported a CY 2025 turnover of €742 million and has 4,500 employees. Besides Germany, the company operates through subsidiaries in Romania, the U.K., the U.S., India and Mexico. "MHP brings strong automotive and industrial consulting and implementation experience, with strengths in business transformation, AI, SAP, manufacturing digitalisation, and connected mobility," TCS said.



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RAISING THE BAR

Pant is India's top wicketkeeper run-getter in away Tests



ANI

Rishabh Pant went past M.S. Dhoni to become the country's highest run-getter as a designated wicketkeeper in away or neutral Tests. The left-hander has 2,534 compared to Dhoni's 2,496. Pant also overtook Adam Gilchrist to become the third-highest six-hitter in Test cricket. He has 102 maximums while Gilchrist smashed 100.

PENALTY

Jaiswal and Asitha fined for breaching code of conduct



AP

India opener Yashasvi Jaiswal and Sri Lanka seamer Asitha Fernando were both fined 25% of their match fee for breaching Level 1 of the ICC Code of Conduct during the second Test. The two were involved in a heated exchange on Sunday. One demerit point each has also been added to their disciplinary records.

KNOCKED OUT

Indian women eliminated after a goalless draw with Australia



HOCKEY INDIA

The light faded over the Wagener Stadion in Amstelveen on Sunday, so did India's hopes of making the hockey World Cup semifinals. In a must-win game, an error-strewn Indian women's side paid the price with an uninspiring goalless draw against Australia. India was pipped by Australia on the basis of more goals scored.

MUCH-NEEDED

Szoboszlai's last-gasp goal earns Liverpool a draw with Newcastle



REUTERS

Liverpool's Dominik Szoboszlai scored a last-gasp penalty to earn a 2-2 Premier League draw with Newcastle United. **The results: PL:** Newcastle 2 (Elanga 5, Willock 57) drew with Liverpool 2 (Gakpo 55, Szoboszlai 90+9-pen). **LaLiga:** Atletico Madrid 2 (Pubill 59, Simeone 85) drew with Villarreal 2 (Moreno 66-pen, Mikautadze 78-pen).

Jurel and Pant turn up the heat on a rain-hit day

The two put on 112 for the seventh wicket as India declares its first innings at 503 for nine; Sri Lanka tottering at eight for two in reply; only 56 overs of play possible due to interruptions

INDIA IN SRI LANKA

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

The afternoon turned grim, dark clouds hung low, skyscrapers became silhouettes and vanished entirely from view. The rain was that intense, cascading in waves, just like how Arundhati Roy wrote in *The God of Small Things*: “Slanting silver ropes slammed into loose earth, ploughing it up like gunfire.”

The liquid intervention at 2.13 p.m. lasted 23 minutes. The efficient ground staff at the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground covered the entire turf in sheets and the venue was not ploughed. But the showers forced a break during the second Test's second day at a time when India was coasting against Sri Lanka.

Gradually the clouds receded, the sun emerged and play resumed at 4.22 p.m., with India placed on 475 for eight and Dhruv Jurel on 95.

He took his time, was stationary on 99 for a while before scampering for a single after tapping Asitha Fernando towards mid-off. Later he hoisted the seamer for a big six.

SCOREBOARD

INDIA — 1ST INNINGS
Yashasvi Jaiswal b Asitha 45 (53b, 9x4), K.L. Rahul c Dickwella b Kumara 18 (33b, 2x4, 1x6), Devdutt Padikkal b Nuwantha 117 (193b, 12x4), Shubman Gill c Dickwella b Asitha 50 (108b, 6x4), Rishabh Pant c Udara b Nuwantha 63 (89b, 6x4, 2x6), Ravindra Jadeja b Asitha 43 (83b, 4x4), Dhruv Jurel (not out) 115 (177b, 9x4, 2x6), Saransh Jain c Mishara b Asitha 6 (8b, 1x4), Manav Suthar c Dickwella b Prabath 18 (51b, 2x4), Mohammed Suraj lbw b Prabath 3 (29b), Prasidh Krishna (not out) 4 (7b, 1x4); Extras (b-8, lb-3, nb-3, w-7): 21; Total (for nine wkts. decl. in 138 overs): 503.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-37 (Rahul, 10.4 overs), 2-66 (Jaiswal, 16.6), 3-186 (Gill, 51.5),

Even as Mohammed Siraj left and last-man Prasidh Krishna appeared, Jurel (115 n.o., 177b, 9x4, 2x6) ensured that India crossed 500. Aptly Shubman Gill declared the first innings at 503 for nine.

At close, Sri Lanka was struggling at eight for two with Yashasvi Jaiswal's diving catch to terminate Lahiru Udara's stint being the highlight.

India's batting effort rested entirely on two wicketkeeper-batters – the maverick Rishabh Pant and the efficient Jurel. Their 112-run seventh-wicket partnership anchored India past the 400-mark.

4-281 (Padikkal, 76.2), 5-296 (Jadeja, 84.1), 6-307 (Saransh, 86.5), 7-419 (Pant, 112.1), 8-458 (Suthar, 124.4), 9-489 (Siraj, 136.1).

SRI LANKA BOWLING
Asitha 29-5-106-4, Kumara 20-4-68-1, Prabath 42-7-132-2, Nuwantha 38-3-154-2, Dinusha 3-0-8-0, Dhananjaya 2-0-8-0, Mishara 4-0-16-0.

SRI LANKA — 1ST INNINGS
Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Prasidh 1 (6b), Kamil Mishara (batting) 5 (5b), Prabath Jayasuriya lbw b Suthar 2 (7b); Total (for two wkts. in three overs): 8.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-1 (Udara, 1.2), 2-8 (Prabath, 2.6).

INDIA BOWLING
Siraj 1-0-1-0, Prasidh 1-0-1-1, Suthar 1-0-6-1.

Pant (63, 89b, 6x4, 2x6) fell off the first ball after lunch, while trying to clear long-off against off-spinner Keshara Nuwantha.

Jurel, though, remained calm. Accumulating runs at a steady trot even as he saw Manav Suthar flicker a while before edging left-arm spinner Prabath Jayasuriya.

Farming the strike

After Siraj walked in, Jurel held onto the strike as much as he could while the former defended. Jurel on-drove Asitha for four and then the skies opened up.

Earlier, resuming at the overnight 300 for five, In-

dia lost Saransh Jain as he awkwardly fended a short-pitched delivery from Asitha. But there were no Monday morning blues as Pant, who had retired hurt on the opening day, returned.

Hitting the roof

Lahiru Kumara steamed in and pitched it short around the leg-stump. Pant just swivelled and pulled a massive six that hit the roof. While Jurel remained patient, Pant was busy.

Host skipper Dhananjaya de Silva placed fielders at fine-leg, third-man, backward square-leg and sweeper-cover. Pacers, be it Asitha or Kumara, ran in and bounced, hoping for a miscued hit. Pant remained unruffled, and suffered a few blows too as he ducked and weaved.

He pinched some fours off Nuwantha while Jurel pulled Asitha past the ropes. Prabath found Pant drilling one straight down the ground and soon the batter reached his 50. Jurel too followed suit and then Pant whipped a six off Prabath over mid-wicket as India moved to 419 for six at lunch.

Pant dominated the first act, and it was time for Jurel to flourish in the second part.

He precisely did that for his second Test century.



Perfect mix: Jurel brought up his second Test hundred with a blend of caution and aggression. ANI

Playing Test cricket is a privilege, says Jurel

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Time seemingly paused as Dhruv Jurel batted on 99. With Mohammed Siraj for company, and an anxious Indian camp watching from the dressing room, Jurel took 13 deliveries to move to his coveted hundred while surviving a run out attempt too in the process. His knock deflated host Sri Lanka in the second Test.

Speaking to the media here on Monday and recalling that nervous-nineties phase, Jurel said: “So actually when I was on 99, before that I was getting runs, and on 99, he (Asitha Fernando) started bowling good lengths. When I played that shot (for the hundred), thought it was going past the fielder, that there was a gap, and then I was like oh God!”

On a stop-start day due to the rains, Jurel seemed at ease, and he explained: “I am used to it, because I was here with India A and am aware of the situation, about the (rain) breaks. I was just trying to bat in partnerships and also assess the conditions. Even if



Jurel. AP

I scored a 100 today, tomorrow I will go and start from zero, that's how it is.”

When Sri Lanka turned up for the first innings, Jurel donned the wicket-keeping gloves. Clarifying that move, he said: “Right now, (Rishabh) Pant has a sore right shoulder. We are closely monitoring him. Today I kept wickets, hopefully he will be fit.”

Among the rivals, Jurel lauded Asitha: “It was so hot and he used the short ball. It's not easy for a bowler, and he was really challenging, especially when I was on 99.”

Stressing that playing red-ball cricket is important, Jurel said: “Playing Test cricket is a privilege. We want to play well both in white and in blue”.

Abid's five-for puts North on top; East in command

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Abid Mushtaq's left-arm spin bamboozled West Zone as North secured a 64-run first-innings lead on day two of the Duleep Trophy quarterfinals at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Monday.

The Jammu & Kashmir twaker excelled with a fine five for 39 as West, starting from 31 for two, was bundled out for 187, with only Shams Mulani showing a semblance of fight (52, 94b, 7x4, 1x6).

And by the time a combination of bad light and rain ended proceedings, North was 171 runs in the green with Ayush Badoni at the crease on a confident 39 (49b, 5x4), and six wickets and two days remaining.

Abid had served an appetiser late on the opening day by casting West opener Prithvi Shaw with a classic left-arm spinner's delivery. In the opening session of day two, he ran through the middle-order, bowling 11 overs, conceding 13 runs and claiming three wickets.

Chief among those dismissals was that of captain



Wrecker-in-chief: Abid ran through the West Zone middle-order. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

Ruturaj Gaikwad. The Maharashtra batter stepped out of the crease, only for the red cherry to dip and hold its line. Ruturaj tried to cover for his error by offering his pad first. The unimpressed umpire gave him his marching orders.

Two balls later, Urvil Patel was also trapped in front, and it was only apt that Abid provided the finishing touches by sending back No. 10 Tushar Deshpande just before tea to complete a much deserved five-wicket haul.

On the adjacent ground, the contest between East and North East moved at a more frenetic pace.

From an overnight 355 for six, East raked up 467 and then shot out its opponent for a paltry 111, with Tripura medium-pacer Abhijit Sarkar scalping five for 20 runs.

With two days to go and a mammoth 349 runs in the red, India's newest – and weakest – cricket zone has a near-impossible task.

The scores: North Zone 251 & 107/4 in 21 overs vs. West Zone 187 in 65.4 overs (Shams Mulani 52, Abid Mushtaq 5/39). East Zone 467 in 112.5 overs (Kumar Kushagra 55, Sudip Gharami 146, Shahbaz Ahmed 167) vs. North East Zone 111 in 42.5 overs (Abhijit Sarkar 5/20) & 7/0 in one over.

I believe in speed and staying straight

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

In Jammu & Kashmir's historic Ranji Trophy triumph in 2025-26, Abid Mushtaq was a silent warrior. In 10 matches, he took only 20 wickets, and in the knock-out stages, just four from three games.

But on day two of North Zone's Duleep Trophy quarterfinal versus West Zone, the left-arm spinner showed his real worth by picking up his 10th First Class five-wicket haul (five for 39).

Guile and control

The 29-year-old was indeed helped by a red-soil pitch that gripped and offered sufficient turn. But Abid also displayed sufficient guile and control, without getting carried away.

“I try to bowl within the stumps and it's very difficult to play that,” Abid told reporters on Monday. “My plan is to use the crease. Sometimes I bowl from height, and sometimes from the base. I believe in [higher] speed and staying straight.”

Abid's methods are straight out of the Ravindra Jadeja playbook, and it was for this reason that the visiting Australians signed



Abid celebrates a wicket with Arshdeep. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

him up as a net bowler in 2023 ahead of the Test series. But back home in the Chenab valley of Jammu region, he had few red-soil wickets to practise on.

Abid credits his improvement to the better infrastructure now available and also to the support of those like P. Krishna Kumar, J&K's bowling coach for the last three years.

“There were more green wickets,” Abid said. “Now we have a variety of pitches... red and black soil. When the wicket is of red soil, I have a lot of confidence. I get goose-bumps.”

No wonder he made the West Zone batters dance to his tune.

India crashes out after another lacklustre show

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Aashin Prasad
AMSTELVEEN

Sukhjeet Singh put his arms aloft in celebration after scoring a goal in the 57th minute. But it was his side's second to Argentina's five as its World Cup run was nearing the end. It summed up India's day at the Wagener Stadion on Monday.

Twenty three years ago, it was in this very arena, where India scripted one of its greatest comebacks, overturning a 2-4 deficit in 15 minutes to beat Pakistan 7-4 in the Champions Trophy. Needing a big win to stay alive in the men's World Cup, there was to be no repeat story from the current class as it went down 5-3.

A sloppy display from Craig Fulton's men was picked apart by a ruthless Argentina. The defeat was India's third in five games in this World Cup. The former champion also let in 16 goals – the most it has conceded since the 2010 edition. Finishing last in Pool E, India will play the seventh-place classification game against Belgium. India got off to a dread-



Cashing in: Argentina made India pay for its defensive errors. HOCKEY INDIA

ful start as Argentina capitalised on its defensive errors.

Inside 40 seconds, a failed clearance allowed an unmarked Joaquin Toscani slot home for the first.

Four minutes later, indecision from Yashdeep Siwach resulted in the defender conceding a penalty corner, which Nicolas Della Torre pushed low and hard to make it 2-0.

India found a lifeline through Sukhjeet as he scored with a backhand finish.

Better control prevailed in the second quarter before further mistakes proved to be India's undoing once again. Mohith H.S. could do nothing to

stop Tomas Domene's fiercely-struck reverse-hit.

Yashdeep's day got only worse when his backpass was intercepted inside the 25 yards before the resulting shot on target struck his foot. Domene made no mistake from the spot to make it 4-1. With eight minutes to go, Lucas Toscani added a fifth from a tight angle.

A late resurgence saw India reduce the margin with another goal from Sukhjeet before Hardik Singh converted a penalty stroke.

The result: Argentina 5 (Joaquin Toscani 1, Della Torre 5-pc, Domene 32 & 44-ps, Lucas Toscani 52) bt India 3 (Sukhjeet 9 & 57, Hardik 60-ps).

Alok Bhattacharya
Gayatri Saberwal

What Galileo missed

U.K. forecasts 'biggest' El Niño yet will break heat records

\$RM,RMF